



DEED OF DECLARATION OF PUBLIC CHARITABLE EDUCATIONAL TRUST ACADEMIA KHAP

Executed On: ____ / ____ / 2026
Executed At: Jhajjar, Haryana, India

Constituted By

Trustee Name	Designation
Mr. Harsh Chaudhary	Chairman & Founding Trustee
Mr. Deepak Dhillon	Managing Trustee & Founding Trustee
Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist	Trustee

For the Purpose Of

Historical Research; Cultural Preservation; Educational Development; Academic Publications; Community Welfare; Social Awareness; Documentation; Research Grants; Scholar Support; Linguistic & Social Studies; Public Educational Activities

Registered Office

House / Building No.	
Street / Locality / Village	
Tehsil / Area	
District	Jhajjar
State	Haryana
PIN Code	
Country	India

Nature of Institution: Public Charitable Educational Trust

Legal Name: ACADEMIA KHAP

This Trust is established for charitable, educational, research, and public welfare purposes and shall function in accordance with the applicable laws of India and the State of Haryana.



Index / Table of Contents

Clause No.	Particulars	Page No.
1	Title Page	1
2	Index / Table of Contents	2
3	Deed of Declaration & Recitals / Background Clauses	4
4	Definitions	5
5	Name of the Trust	7
6	Registered Office of the Trust	8
7	Nature & Legal Status of the Trust	9
8	Objects of the Trust	11
9	Recognition of Founding Trustees	15
10	Board of Trustees	16
11	Chairman of the Trust	17
12	Managing Trustee of the Trust	18
13	Equality of Powers, Rights & Legal Authority	19
14	Voting, Governance & Decision-Making	21
15	Meetings of Trustees	23
16	Quorum for Trustee Meetings	25
17	Appointment of Trustees	27
18	Removal, Suspension & Cessation of Trustee	29
19	Resignation of Trustee	31
20	Vacancy, Succession & Filling of Trustee Position	33
21	Powers, Functions & Authority of Trustees	34
22	Financial Powers of the Trust	37
23	Banking, Financial Account Operations & Signatory Authority	40
24	Donations, Grants, Funding & Financial Assistance	42
25	Scholar Engagement, Research Contracts, Fellowships & Honorarium	45
26	Trustee Remuneration, Reimbursement, Honorarium & Expenses	48
27	Property, Assets & Ownership of the Trust	51
28	Books of Accounts, Record Keeping & Financial Documentation	54
29	Audit, Accounts Review & Legal Compliance	57
30	Conflict of Interest, Disclosure & Fiduciary Transparency	59
31	Confidentiality, Data Protection & Institutional Information	61
32	Amendment, Modification & Alteration of Trust Deed	63
33	Indemnity, Protection & Limitation of Personal Liability of Trustees	65
34	Common Seal, Custody of Documents & Institutional Records	67
35	Dissolution, Winding Up & Disposal of Trust Assets	69
36	Dispute Resolution, Governing Law & Jurisdiction	71
37	Severability Clause	73
38	Execution, Signatures & Attestation	74
39	Witness Attestation Pages	78
Annexure A	Particulars of Trustees	80
Annexure B	Registered Office Details	83
Annexure C	Trustee Identity & Document Checklist	89





3. Deed of Declaration & Recitals / Background Clauses

This Deed of Declaration of Public Charitable Educational Trust is executed on this ____ day of _____, 2026 at Jhajjar, Haryana, by the persons hereinafter referred to as the Trustees, namely:

1. Mr. Harsh Chaudhary, Chairman & Founding Trustee, hereinafter referred to as the First Trustee;
2. Mr. Deepak Dhillon, Managing Trustee & Founding Trustee, hereinafter referred to as the Second Trustee;
3. Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist, Trustee, hereinafter referred to as the Third Trustee;

collectively referred to as the “Trustees” of Academia Khap.

WHEREAS

3.1 Institutional Background

WHEREAS, the Founding Trustees recognized the growing need for an independent and research-oriented platform dedicated to historical understanding, academic inquiry, evidence-based discourse, cultural continuity, social awareness, and preservation of documented knowledge, particularly relating to communities, history, identity, language, society, and civilizational continuity;

3.2 Purpose of Formation

AND WHEREAS, it was considered necessary to establish a formal institutional body capable of carrying out research, educational, historical, linguistic, cultural, archival, documentary, social, and public welfare activities for the benefit of society without discrimination of caste, creed, religion, region, language, nationality, or economic background;

3.3 Academic & Research Orientation

AND WHEREAS, the Trustees intend that Academia Khap shall function as a research-oriented institution engaged in:

- historical and civilizational studies,
- linguistic and cultural documentation,
- academic publications,
- books, journals, reports, podcasts, and digital media,
- preservation of historical records and archives,
- scholar support, honorarium, and fellowships,
- seminars, workshops, conferences, and educational awareness,
- evidence-based dialogue and public intellectual engagement;

3.4 Historical Documentation & Cultural Continuity

AND WHEREAS, the Trustees acknowledge the importance of preserving historical memory, social understanding, community documentation, cultural continuity, and educational literacy through responsible scholarship, documentation, and research-based public engagement;

3.5 Public Charitable Character

AND WHEREAS, the institution is being established solely for public charitable, educational, research, and public welfare purposes, and not for private profit, personal ownership, or commercial gain, and all activities of the Trust shall be undertaken for public benefit and in accordance with applicable laws;

3.6 Recognition of Founding Trustees

AND WHEREAS, Mr. Harsh Chaudhary and Mr. Deepak Dhillon are hereby recognized as the Founding Trustees of Academia Khap, having conceptualized, initiated, and established the institutional framework of the organization;



Such recognition shall be institutional and historical in nature only, and shall not confer superior legal ownership, unequal governance authority, proprietary rights over trust assets, or overriding powers beyond the provisions of this Deed.

3.7 Intent of Trustees

AND WHEREAS, the Trustees have mutually agreed to establish and administer the Trust under the name “ACADEMIA KHAP” as a Public Charitable Educational Trust, governed through principles of equal participation, institutional accountability, transparency, majority-based decision making, and lawful public benefit.

NOW THIS DEED WITNESSETH AS FOLLOWS:

That the Trustees hereby establish and declare the Trust known as “ACADEMIA KHAP”, to be governed by the terms, conditions, powers, objects, rules, and provisions contained in this Deed.



4. Definitions

Unless the context otherwise requires, the following expressions and terms appearing in this Trust Deed shall have the meanings assigned to them hereinbelow:

4.1 “Trust”

The term “Trust” shall mean and refer to ACADEMIA KHAP, a Public Charitable Educational Trust established under this Deed, including all its activities, operations, institutions, assets, publications, projects, branches, records, funds, and lawful undertakings.

4.2 “Trustee”

The term “Trustee” means any person duly appointed under this Deed to administer and govern the Trust, including a Founding Trustee, continuing Trustee, successor Trustee, or additional Trustee appointed in accordance with this Deed.

4.3 “Founding Trustee”

The term “Founding Trustee” means Mr. Harsh Chaudhary and Mr. Deepak Dhillon, being the persons recognized in this Deed as having conceptualized and established the Trust.

4.4 “Chairman”

The term “Chairman” means the Trustee designated as Chairman of the Trust.

4.5 “Managing Trustee”

The term “Managing Trustee” means the Trustee designated as Managing Trustee of the Trust.

4.6 “Beneficiary”

The term “Beneficiary” shall mean any person, group, scholar, institution, researcher, student, community, or member of the public who may directly or indirectly benefit from the charitable, educational, welfare, research, historical, cultural, documentary, or awareness-related activities of the Trust.

The Trust shall function for public benefit, and no individual shall possess proprietary entitlement over Trust assets solely by reason of being a beneficiary.

4.7 “Corpus”

The term “Corpus” shall mean and include all movable and immovable assets, donations, grants, endowments, subscriptions, voluntary contributions, funds, investments, properties, research material, intellectual property, archives, publications, equipment, bank balances, and any other lawful assets belonging to or held by the Trust.

Such Corpus shall remain the exclusive property of the Trust and shall not vest personally in any Trustee.

4.8 “Resolution”

The term “Resolution” shall mean a formal decision or determination passed by the Trustees during a duly convened meeting or through documented written consent in accordance with this Trust Deed.

A Resolution may concern:

- financial matters,
- appointment of Trustees,
- administrative matters,



- scholar engagement,
- expenditure approvals,
- institutional collaborations,
- amendments,
- operational decisions,
- or any lawful matter concerning the Trust.

4.9 “Majority Vote”

“Majority Vote” means approval by more than fifty percent (50%) of Trustees present and entitled to vote on a matter.

For avoidance of doubt, where the Board consists of three Trustees, two affirmative votes shall constitute a valid majority.

4.10 Interpretation

Words importing the singular shall include the plural and vice versa, words importing masculine gender shall include feminine and neutral genders, and references to persons shall include institutions, entities, organizations, and lawful successors wherever the context permits.

5. Name of the Trust

5.1 Legal Name

The name and legal designation of the Trust established under this Deed shall be:

“ACADEMIA KHAP”

and the same shall hereinafter be referred to as the “Trust”, unless the context otherwise requires.

5.2 Use of Name

The Trust shall conduct its activities, communications, publications, documentation, research, academic initiatives, institutional collaborations, charitable activities, digital platforms, educational programs, bank accounts, legal records, and all official affairs under the name:

ACADEMIA KHAP

Any logo, digital handle, publication identity, or public-facing representation used by the Trust shall remain consistent with the legal name ACADEMIA KHAP and the objectives of this Deed.

5.3 Protection of Institutional Identity

No Trustee, employee, volunteer, member, collaborator, or third party shall claim personal ownership, proprietary rights, exclusive control, or independent entitlement over the name “ACADEMIA KHAP”, which shall remain the institutional identity of the Trust.

The name, goodwill, records, logos, publications, digital assets, intellectual property, institutional archives, and reputation associated with Academia Khap shall vest solely with the Trust and shall be used only for lawful and authorized purposes.

5.4 Change of Name

Any proposal to alter, modify, replace, or legally amend the name of the Trust shall require:

1. A formal Resolution of the Board of Trustees;
2. Approval through Majority Vote; and
3. Compliance with all applicable legal requirements and registration procedures under prevailing law.

No Trustee shall independently alter or represent a change in the legal identity of the Trust without due authorization.

6. Registered Office of the Trust

6.1 Registered Office

The Registered Office of the Trust shall initially be situated within District Jhajjar, State of Haryana, at the following address:

Registered Office Address:

House No.: _____

Street / Village / Locality: _____

Tehsil: _____

District: Jhajjar

State: Haryana

PIN Code: _____

or at such other place as may be determined and approved in accordance with the provisions of this Trust Deed.

6.2 Jurisdiction

The Registered Office of the Trust shall remain within the territorial jurisdiction of the State of Haryana, unless otherwise resolved and lawfully changed by the Trustees in accordance with this Deed and applicable laws.

All notices, correspondence, official communications, legal documentation, institutional records, registrations, and statutory matters of the Trust shall be maintained and conducted through the Registered Office unless otherwise resolved by the Trustees or required by law.

6.3 Change or Relocation of Registered Office

The Registered Office of the Trust may be shifted, relocated, expanded, or changed to another premises within or outside the District of Jhajjar by:

1. A duly passed Resolution of the Trustees;
2. Approval through Majority Vote; and
3. Completion of all applicable legal, banking, administrative, and registration-related formalities.

No single Trustee, including the Chairman or Managing Trustee, shall independently alter or relocate the Registered Office without authorization through Majority Resolution.

6.4 Temporary or Additional Offices

For effective administration and fulfillment of Trust objectives, the Trust may establish:

- branch offices,
- field research offices,
- temporary operational offices,
- archival centres,
- educational or documentation units,
- project offices, or
- collaborative institutional workspaces

at such locations as may be approved by the Trustees through Majority Resolution.

Such offices shall function as extensions of the Trust and shall remain subject to the administrative and legal control of Academia Khap.

6.5 Custody of Records

The primary books of accounts, institutional records, trust resolutions, research documents, archives, financial records, legal papers, and official documentation of the Trust shall be maintained at the Registered Office or at such place as may be authorized by the Trustees.



7. Nature & Legal Status of the Trust

7.1 Nature of the Trust

The Trust established under this Deed, namely “ACADEMIA KHAP”, shall be a Public Charitable Educational Trust, created and administered exclusively for lawful charitable, educational, research, and public benefit purposes.

The Trust shall function as a non-political, non-profit, research-oriented, educational, and public welfare institution in accordance with the provisions of this Deed and applicable laws of India.

7.2 Public Charitable Educational Character

The Trust is established for the benefit of the public at large and for advancement of:

- education,
- research,
- historical documentation,
- cultural preservation,
- social awareness,
- academic publications,
- community welfare,
- evidence-based dialogue, and
- intellectual engagement.

The Trust shall not be formed for the exclusive benefit of any private individual, family, caste, business entity, or proprietary interest.

Any benefits arising from Trust activities shall be directed toward educational, charitable, research, or public welfare purposes in furtherance of the objectives of the Trust.

7.3 Non-Profit Character

The Trust shall operate strictly on a non-profit basis.

No part of the income, property, surplus, assets, grants, donations, subscriptions, or corpus of the Trust shall be distributed among Trustees, except:

- approved honorarium,
- reimbursement of lawful expenses,
- research expenses,
- travel and fieldwork expenditure,
- equipment and operational costs, or
- compensation duly approved in accordance with the provisions of this Trust Deed and solely in furtherance of Trust objectives.

The income and resources of the Trust shall be utilized exclusively for achieving the objectives of Academia Khap.

7.4 Irrevocable Nature of the Trust

The Trust hereby constituted shall be irrevocable in nature.

No Trustee, including the Chairman, Managing Trustee, Founding Trustee, or any future Trustee, shall possess authority to revoke, terminate, dissolve, privatize, or claim personal ownership over the Trust except in accordance with the lawful dissolution provisions contained in this Deed and applicable law.

The Trust shall continue to exist perpetually unless dissolved in accordance with the Dissolution Clause contained herein.

7.5 No Personal Ownership

The Trust, including its:

- name,
- assets,
- corpus,
- donations,
- intellectual property,
- publications,
- archives,
- institutional records,
- bank accounts, and
- movable or immovable property,

shall remain the property of Academia Khap as an institution and shall not vest personally in any Trustee.

No Trustee shall claim proprietary ownership merely by virtue of designation, position, contribution, or participation in the Trust.

7.6 Compliance with Law

The Trust shall function subject to the laws of India and applicable provisions governing charitable, educational, research, and public welfare institutions, including such statutory, financial, taxation, registration, and regulatory requirements as may be applicable from time to time.

8. Objects of the Trust

The primary objects for which the Trust known as “ACADEMIA KHAP” is established are charitable, educational, research-oriented, historical, cultural, social, documentary, and public welfare in nature and shall include, without limitation, the following:

8.1 Historical Research & Documentation

To undertake, encourage, support, promote, finance, commission, and publish historical, archaeological, anthropological, genealogical, civilizational, and documentary research relating to societies, communities, languages, cultures, traditions, migrations, historical continuity, identity, governance systems, and public knowledge.

To collect, preserve, digitize, archive, translate, interpret, verify, and disseminate historical material including manuscripts, inscriptions, oral traditions, documents, maps, records, and community histories.

8.2 Linguistic & Philological Research

To conduct and support linguistic, philological, transliteration, etymological, scriptural, textual, and language-based studies, including historical naming systems, pronunciation traditions, language continuity, linguistic evolution, regional dialects, and documentary interpretation.

To prepare educational and research material concerning language, historical terminology, scripts, transliteration systems, and public literacy.

8.3 Cultural Preservation & Civilizational Continuity

To preserve, document, protect, study, and promote cultural traditions, historical continuity, indigenous practices, civilizational knowledge systems, social memory, community institutions, and heritage awareness.

To undertake projects for preservation of traditional knowledge, customs, values, oral histories, archives, and inter-generational educational continuity.

8.4 Educational Advancement

To promote education, public awareness, knowledge dissemination, intellectual development, critical thinking, and evidence-based learning through formal and informal educational methods.

To establish, support, operate, collaborate with, or assist:

- educational institutions,
- research centres,
- libraries,
- archives,
- learning platforms,
- study circles,
- educational forums, and
- academic collaborations.

8.5 Academic Publications & Research Material

To prepare, publish, commission, sponsor, support, and distribute:

- books,
- journals,
- magazines,
- newsletters,
- reports,
- white papers,
- academic studies,
- research papers,

- documentation projects,
- educational content, and
- public awareness material.

The Trust may publish material in physical, digital, audio, video, or multimedia form.

8.6 Podcasts, Media, Films & Documentaries

To create, develop, produce, support, publish, and distribute:

- podcasts,
- educational videos,
- documentaries,
- digital media,
- interviews,
- lectures,
- historical explainers,
- public discussions, and
- educational broadcasts

through digital platforms, online channels, publications, or institutional partnerships for public educational benefit.

8.7 Research Grants, Scholar Funding & Fellowships

To identify, support, sponsor, commission, fund, collaborate with, or financially assist:

- researchers,
- scholars,
- historians,
- archaeologists,
- linguists,
- students,
- fellows,
- writers,
- academicians, and
- subject experts

through:

- scholarships,
- grants,
- fellowships,
- honorarium,
- stipends,
- consultancy fees, or
- research contracts

for academic, educational, research, historical, cultural, documentary, and public welfare work.

8.8 Honorarium & Professional Engagement

To appoint, engage, hire, compensate, reimburse, or support professionals, researchers, advisors, consultants, legal experts, historians, translators, editors, designers, media professionals, and subject experts for fulfillment of Trust objectives.

The Trust may provide:

- honorarium,
- reimbursement,
- travel expenses,
- fieldwork expenses,
- accommodation,
- operational support,
- equipment funding, and
- reasonable compensation



as approved through Trust procedures.

8.9 Educational Programs & Public Learning

To organize, support, and conduct:

- seminars,
- workshops,
- conferences,
- debates,
- exhibitions,
- lectures,
- public discussions,
- training programs,
- awareness campaigns,
- educational drives, and
- knowledge-sharing initiatives.

8.10 Community Welfare, Relief & Public Benefit

To undertake charitable, educational, relief, humanitarian, and public welfare initiatives including support to:

- economically weaker persons,
- students,
- researchers,
- scholars,
- disaster-affected individuals,
- socially disadvantaged groups, and
- persons requiring educational, emergency, or public welfare assistance.

The Trust may provide or facilitate lawful assistance, aid, relief, welfare, and support during:

- emergencies,
- disasters,
- accidents,
- educational hardship,
- research hardship, or
- other public welfare situations

through direct assistance, partnerships, or institutional support.

8.11 Digital Archives & Documentation

To establish and maintain:

- digital repositories,
- archives,
- libraries,
- databases,
- educational collections,
- media archives, and
- documentary repositories

for preservation and accessibility of historical, educational, linguistic, and research material.

8.12 Social & Legal Awareness

To promote:

- social awareness,
- legal literacy,
- constitutional awareness,
- civic understanding,
- educational literacy,



- rational and evidence-based discourse, and
- responsible public engagement

through publications, campaigns, research, educational outreach, and institutional programs.

8.13 National & International Partnerships

To collaborate, affiliate, partner, cooperate, or enter into lawful arrangements with:

- universities,
- educational institutions,
- trusts,
- societies,
- scholars,
- research institutions,
- NGOs,
- government or semi-government institutions,
- private organizations, and
- international academic bodies

for educational, research, cultural, charitable, and public welfare purposes.

8.14 Grants, Donations, Endowments & Financial Assistance

To lawfully receive, accept, collect, raise, administer, invest, and utilize:

- grants,
- donations,
- subscriptions,
- sponsorships,
- institutional funding,
- endowments,
- gifts,
- voluntary contributions, and
- lawful financial assistance

from persons, institutions, organizations, foundations, trusts, academic bodies, donors, or agencies, whether national or international, subject to applicable laws.

8.15 Incidental & Ancillary Powers

To undertake all lawful, incidental, ancillary, supportive, or connected activities necessary or expedient for achieving the objectives of the Trust.

The objects contained herein shall be interpreted broadly and liberally to ensure long-term institutional continuity and future expansion of Trust activities.

9. Recognition of Founding Trustees

9.1 Founding Trustees

The Trust hereby formally recognizes:

1. Mr. Harsh Chaudhary
2. Mr. Deepak Dhillon

as the Founding Trustees of Academia Khap, having jointly conceptualized, initiated, established, and developed the foundational vision, institutional structure, and organizational framework of the Trust.

Such recognition is granted in acknowledgment of their role in the establishment and institutional development of Academia Khap.

9.2 Nature of Recognition

The designation of “Founding Trustee” shall be recognitional, ceremonial, historical, and institutional in nature only.

Such designation is intended to acknowledge institutional contribution and continuity and shall not be interpreted as creating:

- proprietary entitlement,
- exclusive legal authority,
- superior voting power,
- unequal governance control,
- automatic financial privilege, or
- overriding decision-making authority.

9.3 No Ownership Rights

The Founding Trustees shall possess no personal ownership rights over:

- the Trust,
- Trust assets,
- Trust funds,
- corpus,
- bank accounts,
- donations,
- grants,
- intellectual property,
- archives,
- institutional records,
- publications,
- digital assets, or
- movable or immovable property

merely by virtue of being recognized as Founding Trustees.

All assets, funds, institutional goodwill, intellectual property, records, and property associated with Academia Khap shall vest exclusively with the Trust as an independent charitable institution.

9.4 Equality of Governance

Notwithstanding the recognition accorded to the Founding Trustees, all Trustees shall exercise powers strictly in accordance with this Trust Deed.

The status of Founding Trustee shall not override the principles of equal authority, majority-based governance, or institutional accountability established under this Deed.

Accordingly:



Mr. Harsh Chaudhary and Mr. Deepak Dhillon shall remain subject to the same governance framework, voting process, fiduciary obligations, and institutional responsibilities applicable to all Trustees.

9.5 Continuity of Institutional Legacy

The Trust may acknowledge and preserve the institutional contribution of the Founding Trustees in official records, publications, archives, commemorative material, historical documentation, and organizational history for purposes of continuity and institutional memory.

Such recognition shall not create transferable, inheritable, or proprietary claims over the Trust.

10. Board of Trustees

10.1 Initial Trustees

The management, governance, administration, supervision, and lawful functioning of the Trust shall vest in the Board of Trustees, which shall initially consist of the following persons:

Sr. No.	Name	Designation
1	Mr. Harsh Chaudhary	Chairman & Founding Trustee
2	Mr. Deepak Dhillon	Managing Trustee & Founding Trustee
3	Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist	Trustee

The above-mentioned persons shall constitute the First Board of Trustees of Academia Khap upon execution of this Trust Deed.

10.2 Constitution of Board of Trustees

The affairs, administration, finances, policies, objectives, institutional functions, and activities of the Trust shall be administered collectively by the Board of Trustees in accordance with the provisions contained in this Trust Deed.

The Trustees shall collectively act in a fiduciary capacity for the advancement of the objectives of the Trust.

10.3 Equal Legal Standing of Trustees

All Trustees shall exercise their powers subject to Clause 13 (Equality of Powers, Rights & Legal Authority) and Clause 14 (Voting, Governance & Decision-Making) of this Deed.

10.4 Administrative Designations

For administrative convenience and organizational functioning:

- Mr. Harsh Chaudhary shall act as the Chairman of the Trust; and
- Mr. Deepak Dhillon shall act as the Managing Trustee of the Trust.

These designations shall be administrative and operational in character only and shall not create superior legal powers or unequal authority over other Trustees.

10.5 Collective Governance

The Trust shall function through collective governance and institutional accountability. Material matters shall be decided through Majority Vote in accordance with Clause 14 of this Deed.

10.6 Fiduciary Duty of Trustees

Every Trustee shall act:

- honestly,
- transparently,
- in good faith, and
- in the best interests of the Trust.

Each Trustee shall owe a fiduciary duty toward the Trust and shall refrain from conduct detrimental to the objectives, reputation, finances, or lawful functioning of Academia Khap.

10.7 Continuity of Trusteeship

The Board of Trustees may, from time to time, appoint additional Trustees, remove Trustees, or fill vacancies in accordance with the provisions contained in this Trust Deed.



Until altered in accordance with law and this Deed, the persons named in Clause 10.1 shall remain the duly recognized initial Trustees of the Trust.

10.8 Minimum Trustee Count

The Trust shall ordinarily maintain not fewer than Three (3) Trustees at any given time unless otherwise permitted by applicable law.



11. Chairman of the Trust

11.1 Designation of Chairman

For purposes of institutional coordination, administrative convenience, and organizational functioning of the Trust, Mr. Harsh Chaudhary shall serve as the Chairman of Academia Khap.

The designation of Chairman is created solely for administrative clarity and orderly functioning of the Trust.

11.2 Nature of Position

The office of the Chairman shall be administrative, representative, and coordinative in nature only.

The Chairman shall assist in facilitating the functioning of the Trust and may coordinate institutional activities, meetings, communications, and representation of the Trust wherever required.

11.3 Functions of Chairman

Subject to Clause 13 (Equality of Powers, Rights & Legal Authority) and Clause 14 (Voting, Governance & Decision-Making), the Chairman may perform the following functions:

1. Facilitate and coordinate meetings of Trustees;
2. Assist in agenda setting and institutional planning;
3. Represent the Trust in lawful meetings, collaborations, conferences, discussions, and institutional engagements;
4. Assist in maintaining continuity of institutional functioning;
5. Participate in administrative oversight of Trust activities in coordination with other Trustees; and
6. Perform such lawful duties as may be approved through Trustee Resolution.

11.4 Administrative Limitation

The Chairman shall function as administrative coordinator only. All governance and financial authority of the Chairman shall remain subject to Clause 13, Clause 14, and Clause 23 of this Deed.

11.5 Financial Restrictions

The Chairman shall not independently operate Trust bank accounts, authorize unilateral expenditure, dispose of Trust assets, alter Trust governance, or bind the Trust in material financial matters except in accordance with Trustee Resolution and the provisions of this Deed.

11.6 Accountability

The Chairman shall remain accountable to the Board of Trustees and shall perform duties in good faith, transparency, and in furtherance of the charitable and educational objectives of Academia Khap.

12. Managing Trustee of the Trust

12.1 Designation of Managing Trustee

For purposes of day-to-day administration, operational coordination, implementation of activities, documentation, and institutional management, Mr. Deepak Dhillon shall serve as the Managing Trustee of Academia Khap.

The designation of Managing Trustee is created solely for administrative and operational convenience of the Trust.

12.2 Nature of Position

The office of the Managing Trustee shall be administrative, operational, and coordinative in nature only.

The Managing Trustee may assist in execution of institutional activities, implementation of Trustee decisions, coordination of research, documentation, communication, and lawful administrative matters of the Trust.

12.3 Functions of Managing Trustee

Subject to Clause 13 (Equality of Powers, Rights & Legal Authority) and Clause 14 (Voting, Governance & Decision-Making), the Managing Trustee may perform the following functions:

1. Coordinate day-to-day administration and operational matters of the Trust;
2. Assist in implementation of Trustee Resolutions;
3. Coordinate research activities, publications, documentation, archives, educational initiatives, and institutional projects;
4. Facilitate communication with scholars, institutions, collaborators, consultants, advisors, and professionals engaged by the Trust;
5. Assist in maintenance of records, reports, project documentation, and lawful operational administration;
6. Participate in planning and implementation of seminars, conferences, workshops, publications, media, and awareness activities; and
7. Perform such lawful duties as may be authorized through Trustee Resolution.

12.4 Administrative Limitation

The Managing Trustee shall function as administrative coordinator only. All governance and financial authority of the Managing Trustee shall remain subject to Clause 13, Clause 14, and Clause 23 of this Deed.

12.5 Financial Restrictions

The Managing Trustee shall not independently operate Trust bank accounts, authorize unilateral expenditure, dispose of Trust property or assets, bind the Trust in financial commitments, alter governance structure, or independently enter into material obligations on behalf of the Trust except in accordance with Trustee Resolution and the provisions of this Deed.

12.6 Accountability

The Managing Trustee shall remain accountable to the Board of Trustees and shall discharge duties honestly, transparently, and in good faith toward advancement of the charitable, educational, historical, research, and welfare objectives of Academia Khap.



13. Equality of Powers, Rights & Legal Authority

13.1 Principle of Equality

Notwithstanding the administrative designations of Chairman and Managing Trustee, the Trust shall be governed on the fundamental principle of equality among Trustees.

Accordingly, all Trustees shall possess equal rights, equal powers, equal legal standing, equal governance authority, equal fiduciary responsibilities, and equal voting powers within the Trust.

No designation or title shall be interpreted as creating superior authority over another Trustee.

13.2 Administrative Nature of Designations

The designations of:

- Chairman, and
- Managing Trustee

are created solely for purposes of administrative convenience, organizational coordination, and operational functioning of the Trust.

Such designations shall not confer:

- superior legal status,
- overriding institutional control,
- exclusive governance authority,
- preferential financial power,
- unequal decision-making authority, or
- unilateral rights over Trust affairs.

13.3 Equal Governance Rights

Every Trustee shall enjoy equal rights to:

- participate in governance,
- vote on Trust matters,
- participate in meetings,
- propose resolutions,
- review records,
- participate in financial oversight,
- engage in policy formation,
- contribute to institutional decisions, and
- supervise Trust activities.

No Trustee shall be deprived of participation merely by reason of designation.

13.4 Equal Voting Authority

For all purposes of governance:

Each Trustee shall have one (1) equal vote.

The vote of the Chairman shall carry no superior or casting value, and the vote of the Managing Trustee shall similarly carry no additional legal weight.

No Trustee shall possess:

- veto authority,
- overriding vote,
- unilateral approval rights, or
- exclusive authority to block Majority Decisions.

13.5 Majority-Based Decision Making

All material matters concerning:

- governance,
- appointments,



- finances,
- expenditure,
- projects,
- institutional collaborations,
- scholar engagement,
- policy decisions,
- property, and
- amendments

shall be decided through Majority Vote of Trustees.

Where the Board consists of three Trustees and all are entitled to vote, two affirmative votes shall constitute a valid Majority Decision.

Such Majority Decision shall be binding upon all Trustees.

13.6 No Superior Financial Authority

Financial control of the Trust shall remain subject to:

1. Equal governance authority of Trustees;
2. Majority Resolution where required; and
3. Joint signatory requirements for operation of Trust bank accounts.

No Trustee shall possess superior financial powers or independently exercise financial domination over the Trust.

13.7 Equality Before the Trust Deed

All Trustees, including the Chairman and Managing Trustee, shall remain equally bound by:

- fiduciary duties,
- conflict of interest obligations,
- governance requirements,
- institutional accountability, and
- the provisions of this Trust Deed.

No Trustee shall claim superior legal standing merely due to title, founding recognition, administrative role, or public representation.

13.8 Institutional Intent

The Trustees expressly declare that the institutional intent of Academia Khap is to function through:

collective governance, equal participation, mutual accountability, and majority-based institutional decision making.

Accordingly, the offices of Chairman and Managing Trustee shall remain equal in authority and subordinate to the collective will of the Board of Trustees.

14. Voting, Governance & Decision-Making

14.1 Governance of the Trust

The affairs, administration, governance, finances, institutional policy, charitable activities, educational programs, research initiatives, appointments, collaborations, acquisitions, and other lawful functions of the Trust shall be administered collectively by the Board of Trustees.

The Trust shall function upon the principles of:

- collective governance,
- institutional accountability,
- transparency,
- equal participation, and
- majority-based decision making.

No Trustee shall exercise unilateral or absolute control over the affairs of the Trust.

14.2 Majority-Based Governance

All material matters concerning the administration and functioning of Academia Khap shall be decided through Majority Vote of Trustees.

Unless otherwise specifically provided under this Deed, a Resolution shall be deemed validly passed upon Majority Vote as defined in Clause 4.9 and shall be binding upon all Trustees.

14.3 Matters Requiring Resolution

The following matters shall require approval through Majority Resolution:

- financial expenditure,
- utilization of Trust funds,
- bank-related decisions,
- appointment or removal of Trustees,
- appointment of scholars, fellows, advisors, consultants, or staff,
- institutional collaborations, partnerships, or affiliations,
- acquisition or disposal of property, equipment, or assets,
- publications, major projects, and institutional initiatives,
- amendment of internal policies, and
- all other material matters affecting the Trust.

14.4 One Trustee – One Vote

For all governance matters, each Trustee shall possess one (1) vote. No Trustee shall possess a superior vote, casting vote, veto power, overriding approval authority, or unilateral governance power, subject to Clause 13 of this Deed.

14.5 Validity of Resolution

A Resolution may be passed:

1. During a duly convened meeting of Trustees; or
2. Through documented written consent, electronic communication, signed approval, or recorded institutional communication where immediate action is necessary.

Evidence of approval shall be appropriately documented and preserved in Trust records.

14.6 Emergency Decisions

In urgent circumstances requiring immediate action for the welfare, functioning, protection, or legal compliance of the Trust:

Any two Trustees acting jointly may take provisional action, subject to ratification through Majority Resolution at the earliest reasonable opportunity.



Such emergency action shall not override the general governance framework of the Trust.

Such emergency action shall be limited to urgent necessity and shall not amend governance, alter trusteeship, dispose material assets, incur extraordinary financial liability, or materially bind the Trust beyond immediate institutional necessity without Majority Resolution.

14.7 Deadlock Mechanism

In the event of temporary decision-making difficulty affecting institutional functioning, the Trustees shall endeavor to resolve the matter through consultation and Majority Resolution in good faith.

The final decision of the Majority of Trustees shall prevail and remain binding upon the Trust, subject to this Deed and applicable law.

14.8 Good Faith Governance

All voting and governance decisions shall be exercised:

- honestly,
- transparently,
- in good faith, and
- in furtherance of the charitable, educational, and public objectives of the Trust.

No Trustee shall misuse governance mechanisms for personal gain, obstruction, or conduct detrimental to the interests of Academia Khap.

14.9 Record of Decisions

All major decisions, resolutions, approvals, financial authorizations, and governance actions shall be appropriately documented and maintained as part of the official records of the Trust.

15. Meetings of Trustees

15.1 Trustee Meetings

The affairs, administration, governance, policy decisions, financial matters, and institutional activities of the Trust shall be reviewed and administered through meetings of the Board of Trustees.

Trustee meetings may be conducted:

- physically,
- virtually,
- through video conferencing,
- telephonic discussion, or
- through any other mutually agreed lawful communication method.

All meetings shall be conducted in good faith and for the advancement of the objectives of Academia Khap.

15.2 Annual Meetings

The Trust shall conduct at least one (1) Annual Meeting in every financial year for purposes including, but not limited to:

- review of Trust activities,
- institutional planning,
- financial review,
- research and publication planning,
- scholar engagement,
- future projects,
- welfare initiatives, and
- general governance matters.

The Annual Meeting may also review:

- institutional progress,
- objectives achieved,
- proposed activities, and
- strategic direction of the Trust.

15.3 Ordinary Meetings

In addition to the Annual Meeting, the Trustees may convene ordinary meetings from time to time as deemed necessary for administration of the Trust.

Meetings may be convened for:

- financial approvals,
- operational decisions,
- appointments,
- research projects,
- publications,
- collaborations,
- legal or administrative matters, or
- any issue affecting the functioning of the Trust.

15.4 Emergency Meetings

An Emergency Meeting may be convened whenever urgent circumstances arise requiring immediate institutional attention, including:

- financial urgency,
- legal matters,
- emergencies affecting Trust operations,
- urgent approvals,

- public welfare situations,
- institutional risk, or
- matters requiring immediate response.

An Emergency Meeting may be called by:

- the Chairman,
- the Managing Trustee, or
- any Trustee,

provided reasonable efforts are made to inform the remaining Trustees.

15.5 Notice Period for Meetings

(a) Annual Meeting

A minimum notice period of seven (7) days shall be provided for Annual Meetings unless waived by consent of the Trustees.

(b) Ordinary Meetings

A minimum notice period of three (3) days shall be provided for ordinary meetings unless waived by consent of the Trustees.

(c) Emergency Meetings

For Emergency Meetings:

Short notice, verbal communication, telephonic communication, electronic communication, or immediate notice shall be deemed sufficient where urgency so requires.

No technical defect in notice shall invalidate a meeting if all Trustees participate or subsequently consent to the proceedings.

15.6 Agenda of Meetings

Where practicable, the Trustee calling the meeting shall communicate the agenda, proposed matters, or purpose of the meeting in advance.

However:

Failure to circulate a formal agenda shall not invalidate a meeting where the Trustees mutually agree to deliberate on matters concerning the Trust.

15.7 Minutes of Meetings

A written record of material decisions, resolutions, financial approvals, appointments, and governance actions taken during meetings shall be maintained in the form of Minutes of Meeting.

The Minutes may include:

- date and mode of meeting,
- names of Trustees present,
- matters discussed,
- decisions taken,
- votes recorded (where relevant), and
- action points.

Minutes may be maintained in:

- physical form,
- digital records,
- signed resolutions, or
- authenticated institutional communication.

15.8 Custody of Minutes

The Minutes and records of Trustee Meetings shall be preserved as official records of the Trust and may ordinarily remain under institutional custody at the Registered Office or such place authorized by the Trustees.



15.9 Validity of Decisions

No minor procedural irregularity shall invalidate a meeting where majority participation, good faith, and institutional purpose are established.

Every Trustee shall have equal right to:

- attend meetings,
- participate in discussion,
- express opinion,
- review records, and
- vote upon matters before the Trust.

No Trustee shall be excluded from participation without lawful justification.

16. Quorum for Trustee Meetings

16.1 Requirement of Quorum

No meeting of the Board of Trustees shall transact material business unless the required Quorum is present.

The purpose of Quorum shall be to ensure:

- fair participation,
- institutional accountability,
- collective governance, and
- valid decision-making within the Trust.

16.2 Minimum Quorum

The quorum for any meeting of the Board of Trustees shall not be less than one-half of the total serving Trustees, rounded up to the next whole number, provided that quorum shall in no event be less than Two (2) Trustees.

16.3 Validity of Meeting

A meeting shall be deemed validly constituted where:

1. The Quorum required under Clause 16.2 is present; and
2. The meeting is convened in good faith for lawful Trust purposes.

Presence may be through:

- physical attendance,
- virtual participation,
- video conferencing,
- telephonic participation, or
- any mutually recognized communication mode.

16.4 Decisions in Quorum

Where Quorum is fulfilled, decisions shall be taken in accordance with the Majority Vote requirements of this Deed. No Trustee shall exercise unilateral authority in matters requiring collective approval.

16.5 Absence of Quorum

If Quorum is not available at a scheduled meeting:

1. The meeting may be adjourned; or
2. Re-convened on another date or time as mutually convenient; or
3. Conducted later through virtual or documented communication.

No material Resolution shall be finalized without fulfillment of Quorum, except where emergency provisions under this Deed apply.

16.6 Emergency Quorum Exception

In circumstances involving:

- legal urgency,
- financial emergency,
- public welfare concerns,
- institutional protection,
- compliance matters, or
- urgent operational necessity,

Any Two (2) Trustees acting jointly shall constitute sufficient quorum for provisional action, subject to recording and subsequent confirmation in Trust records.

Such emergency action shall remain subject to principles of good faith and institutional necessity.

16.7 Equality in Quorum

No distinction shall be made between Trustees for purposes of Quorum. The presence of the Chairman, Managing Trustee, or any other Trustee shall carry equal institutional validity, and no specific office bearer shall be mandatory for constitution of a valid meeting.

16.8 Record of Attendance

Attendance of Trustees forming Quorum shall be recorded in:

- Minutes of Meeting,
- signed attendance,
- written confirmation, or
- authenticated institutional communication.

Such records shall form part of the official records of Academia Khap.

17. Appointment of Trustees

17.1 Power to Appoint Trustees

The Board of Trustees shall have the authority to appoint additional, successor, honorary, advisory, executive, research, or independent Trustees as may be necessary for the efficient functioning, continuity, governance, and advancement of the objectives of Academia Khap.

Such appointment shall be made solely in the interest of the Trust and for fulfillment of its charitable, educational, historical, cultural, research, and welfare objectives.

17.2 Eligibility for Appointment

A person may be considered for appointment as Trustee if such person is:

- of sound mind;
- legally competent to contract under applicable law;
- willing to act in the interest of the Trust;
- supportive of the objectives of Academia Khap; and
- capable of contributing to governance, research, education, administration, welfare, documentation, law, policy, finance, or institutional development.

Preference may be given to persons possessing expertise in:

- research,
- history,
- archaeology,
- linguistics,
- education,
- law,
- public administration,
- finance,
- technology,
- media,
- governance, or
- social and community welfare.

17.3 Future Trustee Induction

The Trust may induct additional Trustees whenever deemed necessary for:

- institutional expansion,
- governance continuity,
- subject expertise,
- regional representation,
- research enhancement,
- administrative requirements, or
- public welfare initiatives.

The number of Trustees may be increased by Resolution of the Board of Trustees subject to applicable law.

17.4 Majority Approval Requirement

No person shall be appointed as Trustee unless approved through Majority Vote of the existing Board of Trustees, subject to Clause 13 and Clause 14 of this Deed.

Where the total number of Trustees changes in future, Majority Vote shall continue to govern appointment decisions unless otherwise required by law.

17.5 Procedure for Appointment

Appointment of a Trustee may be made through:



1. Proposal or recommendation by any Trustee;
2. Discussion and consideration by the Board of Trustees;
3. Majority approval through Resolution; and
4. Written consent of the proposed Trustee accepting duties and obligations under this Deed.

The appointment shall be recorded in:

- Minutes of Meeting,
- Trustee Resolution, or
- official institutional records.

17.6 Categories of Trustees

The Trust may appoint, where required:

- Permanent Trustees,
- Executive Trustees,
- Honorary Trustees,
- Advisory Trustees,
- Research Trustees, or
- Subject-specific Trustees

where such appointments remain consistent with the objectives of the Trust and the governance framework established herein.

Such designation shall not automatically confer superior legal authority unless expressly resolved by the Board of Trustees.

17.7 Governance Status of Appointed Trustees

Unless otherwise specifically resolved under this Deed, every appointed Trustee shall be governed by Clause 13 and Clause 14 of this Deed.

17.8 Documentation of Appointment

Upon appointment, a Trustee may be required to furnish:

- proof of identity,
- address proof,
- consent letter,
- declaration of willingness to serve, and
- any other document reasonably required for lawful administration of the Trust.

18. Removal, Suspension & Cessation of Trustee

18.1 Power of Removal

The Board of Trustees shall possess the authority to remove, suspend, or terminate the trusteeship of any Trustee where such action becomes necessary in the interest of:

- institutional integrity,
- lawful governance,
- financial protection,
- public credibility,
- fiduciary responsibility, or
- advancement of the objectives of Academia Khap.

Such removal shall only be undertaken in good faith and through due process as prescribed under this Deed.

18.2 Grounds for Removal

A Trustee may be removed from office upon Majority Resolution of the Board of Trustees if such Trustee:

(a) Misconduct

Commits conduct materially detrimental to the reputation, objectives, functioning, governance, credibility, or lawful interests of the Trust, including:

- serious indiscipline,
- abuse of authority,
- intentional obstruction of Trust functioning,
- conduct bringing disrepute to the Trust, or
- repeated violation of Trust obligations.

(b) Fraud or Dishonesty

Commits, participates in, facilitates, conceals, or knowingly supports:

- fraud,
- forgery,
- falsification of records,
- deceptive conduct,
- dishonest financial activity, or
- any unlawful act affecting the Trust.

(c) Financial Misappropriation

Misuses, misappropriates, diverts, unlawfully controls, conceals, or improperly utilizes:

- Trust funds,
- donations,
- grants,
- institutional property,
- equipment,
- records,
- intellectual property, or
- any asset belonging to Academia Khap.

Any unauthorized withdrawal or misuse of Trust resources shall constitute serious misconduct.

(d) Criminal Conviction

Is convicted by a competent court of law for:

- fraud,
- corruption,
- moral turpitude,
- financial crime,
- violent offence, or
- any criminal act materially affecting suitability to continue as Trustee.

Mere accusation or pending investigation shall not automatically result in removal unless the Board determines continuation would seriously prejudice the Trust.

(e) Persistent Inactivity or Non-Participation

Remains persistently inactive in the affairs of the Trust, including:

- repeated unexplained absence from meetings,
- non-participation in governance,
- prolonged non-responsiveness, or
- failure to reasonably discharge Trustee responsibilities

for a continuous period ordinarily exceeding twelve (12) months, without reasonable justification.

(f) Mental or Physical Incapacity

Becomes incapable of effectively discharging Trustee responsibilities due to:

- legal incapacity,
- severe mental incapacity, or
- permanent inability to participate in governance.

(g) Conflict Against Institutional Interest

Acts in a manner demonstrably prejudicial to:

- the lawful functioning,
- institutional stability,
- financial integrity, or
- public objectives

of the Trust.

18.3 Procedure for Removal

Before removal of a Trustee:

1. The allegations or concerns shall be communicated to the concerned Trustee;
2. The concerned Trustee shall be given reasonable opportunity to explain or respond;
3. The matter may be discussed in a Trustee Meeting; and
4. A Resolution may thereafter be passed.

Removal shall take effect upon:

Majority Vote of the remaining Trustees.

18.4 Voting Requirement

The Trustee whose removal is under consideration shall not vote upon his own removal.

Removal shall require approval of the remaining Trustees entitled to vote. Where the number of eligible voting Trustees changes, removal shall require approval of not less than two-thirds of the eligible voting Trustees, rounded up to the next whole vote, unless a stricter requirement is imposed by law.

18.5 Temporary Suspension

Pending inquiry, clarification, legal proceedings, or institutional review:

The Board of Trustees may temporarily suspend a Trustee through Majority Resolution where immediate continuation may materially prejudice the interests of the Trust.

Suspension shall not automatically amount to permanent removal.

18.6 Vacancy Upon Removal

Upon lawful removal, suspension resulting in cessation, resignation, death, incapacity, or disqualification of a Trustee:

The resulting vacancy may be filled in accordance with the Trustee Appointment Clause of this Deed.



18.7 Protection Against Arbitrary Removal

No Trustee shall be removed arbitrarily, maliciously, or for personal disagreement alone.

The removal power shall be exercised only:

- in good faith,
- for legitimate institutional reasons, and
- in the best interests of Academia Khap.

18.8 Continuity of Trust

Removal of any Trustee shall not affect:

- continuity of the Trust,
- validity of prior lawful actions, or
- existence of Academia Khap as a charitable institution.

19. Resignation of Trustee

19.1 Right to Resign

Any Trustee of Academia Khap, including the Chairman, Managing Trustee, Founding Trustee, or any subsequently appointed Trustee, shall have the right to voluntarily resign from office.

Resignation shall be exercised in good faith and in a manner that minimizes disruption to the functioning and continuity of the Trust.

19.2 Mode of Resignation

A Trustee intending to resign shall communicate such intention through:

- written notice,
- signed letter,
- electronic communication, or
- any documented form of communication capable of reasonable verification.

The resignation shall preferably state:

- intention to resign,
- effective date of resignation, and
- reasons (optional).

Failure to provide reasons shall not invalidate the resignation.

19.3 Notice Period

A Trustee shall provide reasonable prior notice of not less than thirty (30) days before resignation wherever practicable.

However:

The Board of Trustees may waive the notice period by Majority Resolution where circumstances justify immediate resignation or mutual consent exists.

In cases involving health, emergency, relocation, personal hardship, legal constraints, or exceptional circumstances, immediate resignation may be acknowledged without insisting on the full notice period.

19.4 Effectiveness and Acknowledgment of Resignation

Resignation of a Trustee shall not require approval as a condition of validity. It shall become effective upon receipt by the Trust or on the effective date stated by the resigning Trustee, whichever is later.

The Board of Trustees may acknowledge and record the resignation through Resolution or Minutes for institutional, banking, registration, and record-keeping purposes.

19.5 Settlement of Responsibilities

Before cessation of office, the resigning Trustee shall, wherever applicable:

- return Trust property,
- hand over documents,
- provide institutional records in possession,
- settle pending administrative obligations, and
- cooperate in transition of responsibilities.

Such handover may include:

- digital access credentials,
- financial records,
- correspondence,
- equipment,
- research documents, or

- any institutional material belonging to the Trust.

19.6 No Personal Claim After Resignation

Upon resignation:

The Trustee shall cease to hold any governance authority, voting right, operational authority, or representative capacity on behalf of the Trust.

Resignation shall not create any personal ownership claim over:

- Trust property,
- funds,
- donations,
- grants,
- archives,
- publications,
- intellectual property, or
- institutional goodwill.

19.7 Vacancy Upon Resignation

Any vacancy arising due to resignation may be filled by the Board of Trustees in accordance with:

Clause 17 – Appointment of Trustees

through Majority Resolution.

Until such appointment, the remaining Trustees may continue administration of the Trust subject to quorum and governance provisions of this Deed.

19.8 Continuing Obligations

Resignation shall not absolve a former Trustee from:

- accountability for prior acts,
- financial misconduct (if any),
- breach of fiduciary duty, or
- liabilities arising from unlawful conduct during tenure.

19.9 Institutional Continuity

The resignation of any Trustee shall not affect:

- continuity of the Trust,
- validity of existing resolutions,
- legal existence of Academia Khap, or
- ongoing institutional activities.

The Trust shall continue to function through the remaining Trustees in accordance with this Deed.

20. Vacancy, Succession & Filling of Trustee Position

20.1 Occurrence of Vacancy

A vacancy in the office of Trustee shall be deemed to arise upon the occurrence of any of the following events:

- resignation of a Trustee;
- death of a Trustee;
- lawful removal of a Trustee;
- incapacity of a Trustee;
- disqualification under law;
- prolonged inability to perform duties; or
- any other circumstance resulting in cessation of trusteeship.

Any such vacancy shall not invalidate the existence, continuity, or lawful functioning of Academia Khap.

20.2 Continuity of Administration

Upon occurrence of a vacancy, the remaining Trustees shall continue to administer the affairs of the Trust, subject to the quorum, governance, and majority-based decision-making provisions contained in this Deed.

The Trust shall continue to function notwithstanding any temporary vacancy in trusteeship, and no vacancy shall automatically suspend its operations or legal existence.

20.3 Power to Fill Vacancy

The Board of Trustees shall possess authority to appoint a replacement or successor Trustee to fill any vacancy arising within the Trust.

Such appointment shall be undertaken in good faith, in the best interests of the Trust, and in accordance with Clause 17 (Appointment of Trustees) of this Deed.

20.4 Succession to Office Bearer Positions

Where a vacancy arises in the office of Chairman or Managing Trustee, the Trustees may designate another Trustee to such office through Majority Resolution.

Such designation shall remain administrative only and shall not alter the equality of powers among Trustees under Clause 13.

20.5 Documentation of Appointment

Every appointment to fill a vacancy shall be documented through Trustee Resolution, Minutes of Meeting, consent of the appointed Trustee, and such records as may reasonably be required by law or institutional practice.

20.6 Protection of Institutional Stability

No vacancy, succession, or replacement shall affect:

- ownership of Trust assets,
- validity of previous lawful resolutions,
- continuity of projects,
- institutional obligations, or
- legal identity of Academia Khap.

The Trust shall remain a continuing institution independent of individual Trustees.

21. Powers, Functions & Authority of Trustees

21.1 General Powers of Trustees

Subject to the provisions of this Trust Deed and the principles of majority-based governance, the Trustees shall possess full authority to administer, supervise, regulate, manage, and advance the affairs of Academia Khap for fulfillment of its charitable, educational, research, historical, cultural, and welfare objectives.

The Trustees shall exercise powers in good faith, for lawful purposes, and in the best interests of the Trust.

21.2 Research & Scholar Engagement Powers

The Trustees shall have power to:

- identify, appoint, engage, support, collaborate with, or commission:
 - o scholars,
 - o researchers,
 - o historians,
 - o archaeologists,
 - o linguists,
 - o writers,
 - o academicians,
 - o fellows,
 - o consultants,
 - o subject experts, or
 - o research institutions.

The Trust may:

- hire scholars for specific projects,
- commission independent research,
- fund academic studies,
- sponsor documentation projects,
- support fieldwork, and
- engage experts for educational or research purposes.

21.3 Power to Fund Research

The Trustees shall possess authority to:

- sponsor and finance research projects;
- provide research grants, honorarium, fellowships, stipends, or contractual payments;
- support historical, educational, cultural, linguistic, archaeological, documentary, and social studies;
- finance publication of books, journals, reports, and educational material; and
- allocate Trust funds toward research and institutional objectives.

Such expenditure shall be approved through lawful Trust procedures.

21.4 Power to Purchase Equipment & Assets

The Trustees may lawfully acquire, purchase, lease, rent, maintain, repair, replace, or dispose of:

- office equipment,
- computers,
- cameras,
- recording devices,
- archival systems,
- digital infrastructure,
- books,
- research material,
- library resources,

- vehicles,
- software,
- technological equipment, or
- any movable property necessary for Trust activities.

Acquisition or disposal of material assets shall be undertaken through Majority Resolution.

21.5 Power to Acquire, Lease & Maintain Office Space

The Trustees may:

- purchase, lease, rent, hire, establish, or maintain offices, branches, institutions, libraries, archives, educational centres, or operational spaces required for functioning of the Trust.

The Trust may also:

- enter into rental agreements,
- lease arrangements,
- institutional collaborations, or
- temporary office arrangements

for fulfillment of Trust objectives.

No immovable property transaction shall be undertaken without Trustee approval.

21.6 Conferences, Seminars & Institutional Events

The Trustees may organize, conduct, sponsor, collaborate in, or participate in:

- conferences,
- seminars,
- workshops,
- lectures,
- debates,
- symposiums,
- cultural events,
- awareness campaigns,
- educational gatherings,
- research presentations, and
- institutional meetings

for advancement of educational, historical, cultural, research, and welfare objectives.

The Trust may collaborate with institutions, scholars, universities, organizations, and professionals for such purposes.

21.7 Digital Media, Publications & Educational Communication

The Trustees shall possess authority to create, maintain, publish, operate, or distribute:

- websites,
- digital archives,
- podcasts,
- documentaries,
- social media platforms,
- research portals,
- educational videos,
- media channels,
- newsletters,
- blogs, and
- public educational content.

The Trust may utilize digital technology for dissemination of research, education, historical documentation, awareness, and institutional outreach.

21.8 Publication Powers

The Trustees may prepare, publish, commission, support, print, distribute, license, or disseminate:



- books,
- journals,
- magazines,
- research reports,
- white papers,
- articles,
- newsletters,
- educational documents,
- translations,
- historical material, and
- digital publications.

Such material may be released in:

- physical,
- digital,
- audio,
- video, or
- multimedia form.

21.9 Power to Establish Branches & Institutional Units

The Trustees may establish:

- branch offices,
- regional centres,
- research units,
- educational cells,
- libraries,
- archives,
- documentation centres,
- digital wings, or
- affiliated institutional initiatives

within India or internationally, wherever considered beneficial for advancement of Trust objectives.

Such branches shall remain under the governance and control of Academia Khap.

21.10 Financial & Administrative Authority

Subject to Majority Resolution and applicable law, the Trustees may:

- receive grants and donations,
- administer Trust funds,
- incur lawful expenditure,
- appoint staff or consultants,
- enter lawful contracts,
- maintain accounts,
- authorize institutional expenses, and
- undertake all acts reasonably necessary for administration of the Trust.

21.11 Residual Powers

The Trustees may exercise:

all incidental, ancillary, implied, and reasonable powers necessary for proper administration, protection, continuity, and advancement of the objectives of Academia Khap, provided such acts remain lawful and consistent with this Trust Deed.

21.12 Limitation of Powers

For clarity:



No Trustee shall exercise powers unilaterally in a manner contrary to Majority Resolution, equal governance principles, or financial safeguards established under this Deed.

All powers shall remain subject to:

- Majority Vote,
- collective governance, and
- fiduciary responsibility.

22. Financial Powers of the Trust

22.1 General Financial Authority

Subject to the provisions of this Trust Deed, applicable law, and Majority Resolution of Trustees, the Trust shall possess full authority to receive, manage, administer, invest, allocate, expend, preserve, and utilize funds, assets, grants, donations, subscriptions, and financial resources in furtherance of the objectives of the Trust.

The Trustees shall exercise all financial powers:

- honestly,
- transparently,
- prudently, and
- solely in furtherance of the objectives of the Trust.

22.2 Sources of Funds

The Trust may lawfully receive, collect, raise, administer, or utilize funds from:

- donations,
- grants,
- subscriptions,
- sponsorships,
- voluntary contributions,
- institutional support,
- academic collaborations,
- philanthropic assistance,
- research funding,
- endowments,
- charitable contributions,
- educational assistance, or
- any other lawful source,

whether from:

- individuals,
- institutions,
- trusts,
- societies,
- foundations,
- educational institutions,
- corporations,
- philanthropic organizations, or
- national and international lawful entities,

subject to applicable law.

22.3 Power to Utilize Trust Funds

The Trustees may utilize Trust funds for purposes including:

- research projects,
- scholar engagement,
- honorarium,
- fellowships,
- educational programs,
- community welfare,
- conferences,
- workshops,
- publications,
- books and reports,
- podcasts and digital media,
- fieldwork and travel,

- office establishment,
- equipment purchase,
- legal compliance,
- institutional collaborations,
- humanitarian support, and
- administrative expenditure.

All expenditure shall be reasonably connected to the objectives of Academia Khap.

22.4 Financial Decision-Making

Major financial commitments, asset disposal, institutional investment, substantial expenditure, or material utilization of Trust funds shall require Majority Resolution of Trustees, subject to Clause 13 and Clause 14 of this Deed.

22.5 Routine Administrative Expenditure

For day-to-day functioning of the Trust, reasonable operational expenses may be incurred including:

- office rent,
- utilities,
- internet and communication,
- research costs,
- printing and publication,
- software and technology,
- travel and accommodation,
- equipment maintenance,
- legal and administrative expenses, and
- project implementation costs.

Such expenditure shall remain subject to institutional accountability and record maintenance.

22.6 Scholar Funding, Honorarium & Compensation

The Trust may lawfully provide:

- scholarships,
- grants,
- fellowships,
- stipends,
- honorarium,
- consultancy fees,
- project-based compensation, and
- reimbursement of expenses

to:

- scholars,
- researchers,
- historians,
- consultants,
- professionals,
- legal advisors,
- media personnel,
- subject experts, or
- institutional collaborators

engaged for advancement of Trust objectives.

22.7 Trustee Reimbursement & Institutional Expenses

The Trust may reimburse Trustees for lawful and reasonable expenditure incurred in furtherance of institutional objectives, including:



- travel expenses,
- accommodation,
- research fieldwork,
- conferences,
- educational activity,
- documentation,
- equipment purchase,
- communication costs, or
- operational expenses.

Where applicable:

No Trustee shall personally enrich himself through misuse of Trust funds.

All reimbursement or compensation shall remain subject to:

- good faith,
- institutional necessity, and
- reasonable record keeping.

22.8 Power to Acquire Assets

The Trust may purchase, lease, maintain, rent, hold, use, or dispose of movable and immovable assets reasonably required for institutional functioning, including:

- office premises,
- technology infrastructure,
- research tools,
- books,
- library resources,
- vehicles,
- archival material, and
- digital systems.

22.9 Banking Operations

Opening, maintaining, and operating bank accounts or digital financial systems shall be governed by Clause 23 of this Deed.

22.10 Investment Powers

Subject to applicable law and Majority Resolution, the Trust may:

- invest surplus funds,
- place deposits,
- maintain reserve funds, or
- undertake prudent financial planning

for institutional sustainability and continuity.

Speculative, unlawful, or excessively risky activities shall not be undertaken.

22.11 Financial Transparency

All financial activities of the Trust shall be supported by vouchers, invoices, receipts, payment records, banking records, and other reasonable financial documentation.

22.12 No Private Profit

The income, assets, surplus, and resources of the Trust shall be utilized exclusively for advancement of Trust objectives.

No Trustee, office bearer, employee, collaborator, or individual shall claim personal ownership or unlawful private profit from Trust property.

For clarity, lawful:



- honorarium,
- reimbursement,
- compensation, or
- institutional expenditure

shall not be deemed private profit when incurred in furtherance of Trust objectives.

22.13 Residual Financial Powers

The Trustees may exercise:

all lawful financial powers incidental or necessary for proper administration, sustainability, and advancement of Academia Khap, provided such powers remain consistent with this Trust Deed and applicable law.

23. Banking, Financial Account Operations & Signatory Authority

23.1 Power to Open Bank Accounts

The Trust shall have authority to open, maintain, operate, and administer one or more:

- savings accounts,
- current accounts,
- fixed deposit accounts,
- institutional banking facilities,
- payment gateways,
- digital financial systems, and
- lawful financial instruments

in the name of “ACADEMIA KHAP” with any scheduled bank, cooperative bank, financial institution, payment service provider, or lawful financial entity as may be approved by the Trustees. Such accounts shall be maintained solely for the charitable, educational, research, cultural, welfare, and institutional objectives of the Trust.

23.2 Joint Signatory Principle

The Trust shall operate strictly on a joint signatory system.

Any Two (2) Trustees jointly shall be authorized to sign, approve, operate, transact, withdraw, transfer, or administer Trust bank accounts and financial transactions.

Any combination of two Trustees shall be equally valid, and no preference or superior authority shall attach to any combination.

23.3 No Single Signatory Authority

Notwithstanding anything contained in this Deed:

No single Trustee shall independently operate, sign, authorize, withdraw, transfer, pledge, mortgage, encumber, or otherwise control any Trust bank account or financial asset.

No Trustee, including:

- the Chairman,
- the Managing Trustee, or
- any Founding Trustee

shall possess unilateral banking authority.

Single-signature operation shall be deemed invalid unless expressly required by law or unavoidable technical banking limitation and specifically authorized through Majority Resolution.

23.4 Banking Transactions

The Trustees acting jointly may undertake lawful banking activities including:

- account opening,
- deposits and withdrawals,
- issuance of cheques,
- online banking transactions,
- fund transfers,
- fixed deposits,
- payment authorizations,
- grant administration,
- donation receipt,
- reimbursement processing, and
- lawful institutional expenditure.

All banking activity shall remain subject to the objectives of the Trust and principles of accountability.

23.5 Financial Safeguards

Banking records, payment approvals, account statements, vouchers, and supporting documents shall be maintained where practicable to ensure transparency, accountability, and protection of Trust funds. Material financial transactions exceeding limits, if prescribed by Trustee Resolution from time to time, may require prior approval through Majority Resolution.

23.6 Majority Approval for Material Transactions

Major financial commitments including:

- acquisition of major assets,
- institutional borrowing,
- large capital expenditure,
- long-term lease commitments,
- investment decisions, or
- extraordinary financial obligations

shall require: Majority Resolution of Trustees before execution.

23.7 Change in Signatory Authority

In the event of:

- resignation,
- death,
- removal,
- incapacity, or
- replacement of a Trustee,

the Board of Trustees may alter signatory authorization through:

Majority Resolution of Trustees

and may notify the concerned financial institution accordingly.

At all times, banking operations shall continue on a minimum two-signatory basis.

23.8 Digital Banking & Payment Systems

The Trust may utilize lawful:

- internet banking,
- UPI systems,
- institutional payment gateways,
- digital donation platforms,
- accounting software, or
- electronic financial systems

for operational convenience.

No Trustee shall independently control institutional funds in violation of the joint-signatory principle.

23.9 Protection Against Unauthorized Financial Control

No Trustee shall:

- secretly operate Trust funds,
- conceal institutional finances,
- unilaterally divert money,
- maintain undisclosed Trust accounts, or
- exercise exclusive financial control

over Trust assets.

Any such conduct may constitute: financial misconduct and grounds for removal under this Deed.

24. Donations, Grants, Funding & Financial Assistance

24.1 Power to Receive Donations & Grants

The Trust shall have authority to lawfully receive, accept, collect, administer, utilize, and manage financial or non-financial support for advancement of the objectives of the Trust.

The Trust may receive support in the form of:

- donations,
- grants,
- subscriptions,
- sponsorships,
- endowments,
- gifts,
- charitable assistance,
- institutional support,
- research funding,
- educational assistance, or
- any other lawful contribution.

24.2 Indian Funding & Domestic Contributions

The Trust may receive lawful donations, grants, sponsorships, or financial assistance from:

- individuals,
- philanthropists,
- educational institutions,
- charitable bodies,
- corporations,
- trusts,
- societies,
- Section 8 companies,
- academic organizations,
- research institutions,
- community groups, and
- other lawful domestic entities

within India.

Such funding may be utilized for:

- research,
- educational programs,
- scholar support,
- publications,
- welfare activities,
- institutional development,
- digital initiatives,
- conferences,
- equipment purchase, and
- other lawful Trust purposes.

24.3 Institutional Grants

The Trust may seek, receive, administer, or collaborate for grants, assistance, sponsorship, or project-based support from:

- universities,
- colleges,
- research institutions,
- educational organizations,
- think tanks,
- foundations,

- philanthropic institutions,
- public or private institutions,
- government or semi-government entities, and
- national or international academic bodies.

The Trustees may enter into lawful agreements, memoranda, partnerships, or institutional arrangements for grant administration and project implementation.

24.4 National & International Academic Collaboration

For advancement of educational, research, historical, cultural, and public welfare objectives, the Trust may:

- collaborate with scholars,
- universities,
- researchers,
- institutions,
- foundations,
- educational bodies,
- archives,
- museums,
- international organizations, or
- research networks,

whether located within or outside India.

Such collaborations may include:

- joint research,
- educational projects,
- conferences,
- publications,
- fellowships,
- cultural documentation,
- digital archives, or
- academic exchange.

Such collaboration shall remain consistent with applicable Indian law.

24.5 International Contributions, Foreign Funding & FCRA Compliance

The Trust may, subject to applicable law, seek or receive lawful support, collaboration, grants, donations, educational funding, research assistance, or philanthropic support from foreign individuals, institutions, foundations, educational bodies, or charitable organizations.

Foreign contribution shall be accepted only in accordance with applicable law, including the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010 (“FCRA”) and rules made thereunder, and only after obtaining registration, prior permission, or other approval where legally required.

Foreign contributions shall be received through legally approved banking mechanisms, properly recorded, reported, and utilized in accordance with law, and no Trustee shall independently receive foreign funds in the name of the Trust outside lawful institutional channels.

24.6 Non-Financial Contributions

The Trust may also receive lawful non-financial support including:

- books,
- research material,
- equipment,
- software,
- technology,
- educational resources,
- archival material,
- office infrastructure,
- professional services, or



- volunteer support
- for fulfillment of Trust objectives.

24.7 Restricted & Unlawful Contributions

The Trust shall not knowingly receive:

- unlawful funding,
- proceeds of crime,
- anonymous prohibited funding,
- illegal political funding, or
- contributions prohibited under law.

The Trustees may refuse any donation or grant deemed inconsistent with:

- institutional integrity,
- public credibility,
- legal compliance, or
- objectives of the Trust.

The Trust may decline any contribution, grant, donation, or funding inconsistent with institutional independence, academic integrity, lawful functioning, or the objectives of the Trust.

24.8 Utilization of Donations & Grants

All grants, donations, contributions, and institutional assistance shall be utilized solely for: the objectives of the Trust.

No Trustee shall personally appropriate Trust funding for private enrichment.

For clarity, lawful:

- honorarium,
- reimbursement,
- approved project compensation, or
- institutional expenditure

shall not be construed as personal enrichment where connected to Trust objectives.

24.9 Transparency & Documentation

The Trust shall maintain reasonable records of:

- donations received,
- grants administered,
- utilization of funds,
- donor communications,
- project expenditure, and
- institutional financial records

to ensure accountability and transparency.

25. Scholar Engagement, Research Contracts, Fellowships & Honorarium

25.1 Power to Engage Scholars & Experts

In furtherance of the objectives of the Trust, the Trust shall possess authority to identify, appoint, engage, collaborate with, commission, support, or fund qualified persons and institutions.

The Trust may engage:

- scholars,
- researchers,
- historians,
- archaeologists,
- linguists,
- academicians,
- writers,
- translators,
- legal researchers,
- data analysts,
- documentary researchers,
- policy experts,
- consultants,
- fellows,
- students, or
- subject specialists.

Such engagement may be temporary, contractual, honorary, project-based, institutional, or long-term in nature.

25.2 Scholar Hiring & Research Engagement

The Trustees shall have authority to appoint or commission scholars for:

- independent research projects,
- historical investigation,
- linguistic studies,
- educational programs,
- documentary preparation,
- archival work,
- field research,
- survey and evidence collection,
- publication projects,
- legal or policy analysis,
- social documentation, and
- any activity reasonably connected to Trust objectives.

The Trust may also engage external institutions, experts, universities, or professional collaborators where necessary.

25.3 Research Contracts

The Trust may enter into lawful:

- research agreements,
- consultancy contracts,
- institutional collaborations,
- project agreements,
- documentation assignments, or
- academic partnerships

with individuals or institutions for carrying out activities in furtherance of the objectives of the Trust.

Such contracts may define:

- scope of work,

- duration,
- deliverables,
- research expectations,
- confidentiality obligations,
- intellectual property arrangements,
- reimbursement terms, and
- compensation structure.

All contracts shall remain consistent with the charitable and educational objectives of the Trust.

25.4 Honorarium & Compensation

The Trust may provide lawful:

- honorarium,
- project-based compensation,
- consultancy fees,
- research payments,
- stipends,
- reimbursements, or
- reasonable professional compensation

to scholars, experts, researchers, or institutions engaged for Trust work.

Compensation may be approved for:

- intellectual contribution,
- research output,
- project completion,
- documentation work,
- lectures,
- training,
- advisory work, or
- institutional contribution.

Where applicable:

Such compensation shall be reasonable, transparent, and directly connected to fulfillment of Trust objectives.

25.5 Fellowships & Research Support

The Trust may establish, administer, sponsor, or support:

- research fellowships,
- academic fellowships,
- educational grants,
- research sponsorships,
- student fellowships,
- scholar support programs, or
- thematic study programs.

Such fellowships may include:

- financial support,
- travel assistance,
- fieldwork funding,
- accommodation support,
- access to archives,
- mentorship, or
- research infrastructure.

25.6 Project-Based Scholar Engagement

The Trust may appoint scholars or professionals on:

- fixed-term basis,
- project-specific basis,



- consultancy basis,
- milestone-based engagement, or
- output-based arrangements.

Such engagement may terminate automatically upon completion of the assigned project unless extended by Resolution of Trustees.

25.7 Intellectual Property & Research Ownership

Unless otherwise specifically agreed through written contract:

Research, reports, publications, documentation, educational material, digital media, and scholarly output created through Trust funding or institutional engagement shall ordinarily vest with Academia Khap for charitable and educational purposes.

Due academic credit may be granted to contributing scholars wherever appropriate.

25.8 Approval Mechanism

Appointment of scholars, research contracts, fellowships, and honorarium shall require: Majority Resolution of Trustees.

For the purposes of Academia Khap:

Approval of at least Two (2) Trustees shall be sufficient.

25.9 Ethical & Academic Standards

All scholarly work supported by the Trust shall, to the extent practicable, encourage:

- evidence-based research,
- academic integrity,
- responsible documentation,
- lawful conduct,
- source-based analysis, and
- intellectual honesty.

The Trustees may discontinue support where conduct materially undermines institutional credibility or lawful objectives.

26. Trustee Remuneration, Reimbursement, Honorarium & Expenses

26.1 General Principle

The Trustees of Academia Khap shall ordinarily serve the Trust in a fiduciary and charitable capacity.

However, recognizing that Trustees may incur personal expenditure, dedicate professional time, conduct research, undertake fieldwork, and contribute operational efforts toward fulfillment of Trust objectives:

The Trust may reimburse reasonable, bona fide expenses and provide lawful honorarium, stipend, or compensation where necessary, institutionally justified, and directly connected to the objectives of the Trust.

Such payments shall not constitute personal profit or ownership of the Trust.

26.2 Travel Reimbursement

The Trust may reimburse Trustees for reasonable, bona fide travel expenses directly connected to the objectives of the Trust, including:

- field visits,
- research travel,
- conferences,
- seminars,
- institutional meetings,
- documentation work,
- educational activities,
- welfare activities,
- legal or administrative compliance, and
- collaborative engagements.

Travel reimbursement may include:

- airfare,
- train fare,
- taxi expenses,
- local transport,
- fuel costs,
- toll charges,
- accommodation,
- meals, and
- incidental travel expenditure.

Such expenses shall be reasonable, bona fide, and directly connected to the objectives of the Trust.

26.3 Research & Academic Expenses

The Trust may reimburse or support expenditure incurred by Trustees for:

- historical research,
- academic investigation,
- archive access,
- document acquisition,
- field documentation,
- survey work,
- library access,
- subscriptions,
- educational material,
- scholarly databases,
- legal research,
- translation work, or
- research assistance.

Such expenses may be approved where reasonable, bona fide, and directly connected to the objectives of the Trust.

26.4 Equipment & Operational Support

The Trust may purchase, reimburse, finance, or provide equipment that is reasonable, bona fide, and directly connected to the objectives of the Trust, including:

- laptops,
- computers,
- mobile devices,
- cameras,
- recording equipment,
- microphones,
- drones,
- software,
- research tools,
- internet infrastructure,
- storage devices,
- printing equipment, or
- any technology or instrument necessary for Trust activities.

Where equipment is acquired through Trust funds:

Such equipment shall ordinarily remain the property of the Trust unless otherwise approved through Resolution.

26.5 Fieldwork & Documentation Expenses

Trustees conducting fieldwork, documentation, surveys, interviews, historical exploration, archaeological observation, or educational outreach may be reimbursed for reasonable, bona fide expenses directly connected to the objectives of the Trust, including:

- travel costs,
- lodging,
- photography or videography expenses,
- document procurement,
- archival access,
- local logistical support,
- translation expenses,
- communication costs, and
- reasonable incidental expenditure.

The Trust may also support extended research projects requiring on-ground investigation.

26.6 Trustee Honorarium & Stipend

Where the Trustees devote substantial time, operational effort, research contribution, institutional management, or field engagement toward Trust activities:

The Trust may provide reasonable, bona fide honorarium, stipend, project-based compensation, or operational support directly connected to the objectives of the Trust.

Such support may be provided for:

- full-time or substantial involvement,
- institutional management,
- research leadership,
- project execution,
- field investigation,
- publication management,
- digital operations, or
- other Trust-related responsibilities.

Where applicable:



Any honorarium or stipend shall be reasonable, bona fide, transparent, proportionate to the institutional needs and financial capacity of the Trust, and directly connected to the objectives of the Trust.

26.7 Approval Requirement

No Trustee shall unilaterally approve remuneration, reimbursement, stipend, or honorarium for himself.

Accordingly:

Any reimbursement, stipend, honorarium, or financial support to a Trustee shall require Majority Resolution of the remaining Trustees.

For the purposes of Academia Khap:

Approval of at least Two (2) Trustees shall be sufficient.

Where the concerned Trustee is beneficiary of payment:

Such Trustee shall abstain from voting on his own remuneration matter.

26.8 No Personal Enrichment

Trustee remuneration shall not be interpreted as private ownership or profit.

No Trustee shall misuse institutional funds for:

- excessive compensation,
- disguised profit extraction,
- personal luxury expenditure, or
- expenditure unrelated to Trust objectives.

All payments shall remain reasonable, bona fide, and directly connected to institutional necessity, good faith, and the objectives of the Trust.

26.9 Financial Record Requirement

The Trust shall maintain reasonable records concerning:

- reimbursement claims,
- approved honorarium,
- travel expenditure,
- equipment purchase,
- fieldwork support, and
- Trustee-related expenses

through receipts, vouchers, invoices, approvals, or institutional documentation.

27. Property, Assets & Ownership of the Trust

27.1 Ownership of Trust Property

All movable and immovable property, assets, funds, resources, records, intellectual property, and institutional holdings acquired, received, created, purchased, leased, funded, developed, or maintained in the name of Academia Khap shall exclusively belong to the Trust as an independent charitable institution.

Accordingly:

All Trust assets shall vest solely in Academia Khap and not in any individual Trustee, office bearer, contributor, donor, employee, collaborator, or beneficiary.

27.2 Scope of Trust Assets

For the purposes of this Deed, the term “Trust Assets” shall include:

(a) Financial Assets

- bank accounts,
- cash balances,
- grants,
- donations,
- subscriptions,
- endowments,
- investments,
- institutional reserves, and
- financial receivables.

(b) Movable Property

- computers,
- laptops,
- mobile devices,
- cameras,
- microphones,
- drones,
- software,
- office furniture,
- vehicles,
- books,
- archival material,
- equipment, and
- technological infrastructure.

(c) Immovable Property

- office premises,
- research centres,
- libraries,
- educational facilities,
- leased or owned buildings, and
- any land or immovable property lawfully acquired by the Trust.

(d) Intellectual Property & Institutional Material

- books,
- publications,
- journals,
- research papers,
- databases,
- reports,
- archives,
- educational content,
- podcasts,
- documentaries,

- websites,
- software systems,
- trademarks,
- logos,
- branding,
- social media assets, and
- digital repositories.

27.3 Institutional Ownership Principle

All assets, goodwill, institutional reputation, archives, publications, and intellectual property created through:

- Trust funding,
- institutional effort,
- scholar engagement,
- Trustee effort in official capacity, or
- activities conducted under the name of Academia Khap

shall ordinarily remain the property of the Trust.

Where applicable:

No Trustee shall claim personal ownership over Trust-created institutional assets merely because of participation, designation, financial contribution, founding status, or administrative involvement.

27.4 No Personal Ownership Rights

No Trustee, including:

- the Chairman,
- Managing Trustee,
- Founding Trustee, or
- any future Trustee

shall possess personal ownership rights over:

- Trust property,
- donations,
- grants,
- institutional funds,
- equipment,
- publications,
- intellectual property,
- bank balances,
- archives, or
- institutional goodwill.

Accordingly:

Trust property shall not be treated as personal property of any Trustee.

27.5 Restrictions on Use of Assets

Trust assets shall be utilized solely for:

the objectives of the Trust.

No Trustee shall:

- misuse Trust assets,
- convert Trust property for personal use without authorization,
- privately sell institutional assets,
- conceal institutional property, or
- divert Trust resources for personal enrichment.

Any misuse may constitute:

misappropriation and grounds for removal under this Deed.



27.6 Acquisition & Disposal of Assets

The Trust may lawfully:

- purchase,
- lease,
- rent,
- license,
- maintain,
- upgrade,
- exchange,
- transfer, or
- dispose of assets

where reasonably necessary for advancement of Trust objectives.

Where applicable:

Major asset acquisition or disposal shall require Majority Resolution of Trustees.

27.7 Custody of Trust Property

The Trustees may designate responsibility for custody, maintenance, supervision, or operational use of Trust assets.

However:

Custody shall not amount to ownership.

Any Trustee holding institutional property shall remain accountable to the Trust.

27.8 Property Upon Resignation, Removal or Death

Upon resignation, removal, incapacity, or death of a Trustee:

No personal claim shall arise over Trust property, funds, equipment, publications, or institutional assets.

The concerned Trustee or legal representative shall return all Trust-related property in possession to the Trust.

27.9 Protection of Institutional Assets

The Trustees shall act to reasonably safeguard:

- institutional property,
- research archives,
- publications,
- financial resources,
- digital assets, and
- intellectual property

against misuse, unauthorized transfer, loss, or unlawful appropriation.

28. Books of Accounts, Record Keeping & Financial Documentation

28.1 Maintenance of Accounts

The Trust shall maintain proper, transparent, and reasonably accurate Books of Accounts, records, registers, and financial documentation concerning its income, expenditure, assets, liabilities, grants, donations, institutional transactions, and activities.

Such records shall be maintained in good faith for purposes of:

- transparency,
- accountability,
- financial discipline,
- legal compliance,
- institutional continuity, and
- responsible administration of Academia Khap.

28.2 Books of Accounts

The Trust shall maintain proper Books of Accounts, including:

- cash book,
- bank book,
- ledger,
- receipts register,
- donation register,
- grant records,
- payment records,
- expenditure statements,
- reimbursement records, and
- institutional financial statements.

The Trustees may maintain such records:

- physically,
- digitally,
- through accounting software, or
- through any lawful and practical record-keeping mechanism.

28.3 Voucher Records

The Trust shall, wherever reasonably practicable, maintain Voucher Records for financial transactions undertaken by the Trust.

Voucher records may include:

- invoices,
- bills,
- receipts,
- payment slips,
- bank acknowledgments,
- travel reimbursement records,
- grant utilization records,
- equipment purchase records, and
- supporting financial documentation.

Where applicable:

Minor or incidental expenditure where formal vouchers are unavailable may be recorded through written expense declaration or approved institutional record.

28.4 Expense Register

The Trust shall maintain an Expense Register or equivalent financial record reflecting:

- operational expenses,



- travel expenditure,
- fieldwork expenses,
- scholar payments,
- honorarium,
- stipends,
- equipment purchases,
- office expenses,
- publication expenditure,
- event costs, and
- institutional expenditure.

The Expense Register may include:

- date of expense,
- nature of expense,
- amount,
- approving authority,
- supporting record, and
- purpose connected to Trust objectives.

28.5 Banking Records

The Trust shall maintain reasonable records relating to:

- bank statements,
- deposits,
- withdrawals,
- transfers,
- grants received,
- donations,
- financial commitments, and
- account operation history.

Such records may be preserved in physical or digital form.

28.6 Custody of Financial Records

The financial records and Books of Accounts of the Trust shall remain in the custody of the Trust at:

the Registered Office or such other location as approved by the Trustees.

The Trustees may authorize maintenance of records by:

- a Trustee,
- accountant,
- consultant, or
- authorized professional,

without divesting the Trust of ownership or control over records.

28.7 Inspection of Records

Every Trustee shall possess equal right to:

inspect, review, verify, or access Books of Accounts, financial records, vouchers, registers, and institutional documentation of the Trust.

No Trustee shall unreasonably conceal or deny access to institutional records.

28.8 Period of Preservation

Financial records, books of accounts, vouchers, receipts, and institutional financial documentation shall be preserved for such duration as may be required under applicable law or institutional necessity.

Where practicable:



Important financial records shall be maintained for a minimum period of eight (8) financial years.

28.9 Record Integrity & Transparency

No Trustee or person associated with the Trust shall:

- intentionally falsify records,
- destroy material documentation,
- conceal financial information,
- manipulate vouchers, or
- misrepresent institutional accounts.

Any such act may constitute:

financial misconduct and grounds for disciplinary action or removal under this Deed.

28.10 Practical Compliance Principle

Recognizing that the scale of Trust activity may vary from year to year:

The level of accounting, documentation, and record keeping shall remain reasonable, proportionate, and practical in accordance with the size, funding, and operational activity of the Trust, while maintaining transparency and institutional accountability.

29. Audit, Accounts Review & Legal Compliance

29.1 Maintenance & Review of Accounts

The Trust shall maintain reasonable financial transparency and institutional accountability through periodic review of accounts, financial records, and expenditure.

The Trustees shall ensure that:

- Books of Accounts are reasonably maintained;
- income and expenditure are appropriately recorded;
- vouchers and supporting records are preserved where practicable; and
- Trust funds are utilized for lawful institutional purposes.

29.2 Annual Review of Accounts

The financial affairs of Academia Khap shall be reviewed at least once during every financial year by the Board of Trustees.

Such review may include:

- income and expenditure statement,
- donations and grants received,
- institutional expenditure,
- reimbursement and honorarium,
- bank account activity,
- pending liabilities, and
- financial sustainability of the Trust.

The Trustees may record observations or approvals through:

- Minutes of Meeting,
- Trustee Resolution, or
- financial review records.

29.3 Audit Depending Upon Legal Requirement

The Trust acknowledges that statutory audit requirements may vary depending upon:

- applicable law,
- annual receipts,
- taxation status,
- registration category,
- grant conditions,
- donor requirements, or
- legal obligations existing at the relevant time.

Accordingly:

The Trust shall conduct audit, financial review, or certification of accounts whenever required under applicable law or institutional necessity.

29.4 Small Funding Years

Recognizing that Trust activity and annual receipts may fluctuate and may sometimes remain minimal:

Even during years of small funding or limited financial activity, the Trustees shall ensure reasonable internal review of accounts and maintenance of basic financial transparency.

Where formal statutory audit is not legally mandatory:

- internal financial review,
- Trustee verification, or
- basic accounts examination

may ordinarily suffice, subject to law.

29.5 Appointment of Auditor or Professional Assistance

Where legally required or institutionally necessary, the Trustees may appoint:

- Chartered Accountant,
- Auditor,
- Financial Consultant,
- Compliance Professional, or
- other qualified person

for:

- audit,
- filing assistance,
- financial review,
- taxation matters, or
- compliance support.

Where applicable:

The Trust shall remain free to adopt practical and proportionate accounting arrangements based upon scale of operations and legal requirements.

29.6 Compliance with Law

The Trust shall comply with:

- registration requirements,
- financial disclosure obligations,
- taxation laws,
- charitable institution requirements,
- banking regulations, and
- any other legal obligations

to the extent applicable under prevailing law.

Where applicable:

Nothing in this Clause shall compel unnecessary procedural burden beyond what is legally required for the scale and functioning of the Trust.

29.7 Trustee Responsibility

The Trustees shall act in good faith to ensure that:

- institutional finances remain transparent,
- misuse of funds is prevented,
- statutory obligations are reasonably complied with, and
- records are maintained for lawful review.

No Trustee shall intentionally conceal material financial information from the Trust.

30. Conflict of Interest, Disclosure & Fiduciary Transparency

30.1 Duty of Loyalty & Good Faith

Every Trustee of Academia Khap shall act:

- honestly,
- transparently,
- in good faith, and
- in the best interests of the Trust.

Each Trustee owes a fiduciary duty toward the Trust and shall avoid situations where personal, financial, professional, institutional, or family interests materially conflict with the objectives or proper functioning of the Trust.

30.2 Meaning of Conflict of Interest

A Conflict of Interest shall arise where a Trustee's personal, financial, professional, institutional, familial, commercial, or external interest may:

- influence decision-making,
- impair impartial judgment,
- create unfair advantage,
- compromise institutional integrity, or
- reasonably appear to affect objective administration of the Trust.

Conflict of Interest may be:

- actual,
- potential, or
- perceived.

30.3 Trustee Disclosure Requirement

Where any Trustee has a direct or indirect interest in any matter before the Trust:

The concerned Trustee shall disclose such interest fully and in good faith to the Board of Trustees at the earliest reasonable opportunity.

Disclosure shall ordinarily be made where the Trustee:

- has financial interest in a transaction,
- is associated with an institution involved in Trust work,
- may personally benefit from a proposed arrangement,
- has family or business connection affecting neutrality, or
- possesses any competing institutional interest.

The disclosure may be recorded in:

- Minutes of Meeting,
- Trustee Resolution, or
- institutional records.

30.4 Participation in Decision

Where a material Conflict of Interest exists:

The concerned Trustee shall ordinarily abstain from voting or decision-making upon the concerned matter.

The remaining Trustees may deliberate and decide the matter through Majority Resolution.

Where applicable:

Disclosure itself shall not automatically disqualify a Trustee from institutional participation unless the conflict materially affects fairness or objectivity.

30.5 Examples of Conflict of Interest

Illustratively, Conflict of Interest may include:

- a Trustee awarding paid work to himself;
- approving personal reimbursement without Trustee approval;
- engaging family members without disclosure;
- entering financial contracts benefiting a Trustee personally;
- diverting Trust opportunities for personal gain;
- competing institutional interests adversely affecting Academia Khap.

30.6 Trustee Remuneration Exception

Payments lawfully permitted under this Deed including:

- honorarium,
- stipend,
- reimbursement,
- project compensation, or
- approved institutional support

shall not constitute prohibited Conflict of Interest where:

such payment is transparently disclosed, institutionally justified, reasonably connected to Trust objectives, and approved through Majority Resolution of non-beneficiary Trustees.

30.7 Prohibited Conduct

No Trustee shall:

- misuse position for private gain,
- conceal material interest,
- secretly benefit from Trust transactions,
- manipulate decisions for personal advantage, or
- intentionally compromise institutional integrity.

Any serious concealment or misuse may constitute:

misconduct and grounds for removal under this Deed.

30.8 Resolution of Conflict

Where uncertainty exists regarding a possible Conflict of Interest:

The matter shall be discussed by the Trustees and resolved through Majority Decision in good faith.

The Trustees may seek external professional or legal guidance where necessary.

30.9 Record of Disclosure

Conflict disclosures and related decisions shall be documented and preserved as part of the institutional records of the Trust.

31. Confidentiality, Data Protection & Institutional Information

31.1 Duty of Confidentiality

Every Trustee, advisor, scholar, employee, consultant, volunteer, collaborator, or person associated with Academia Khap shall act in good faith to preserve the confidentiality, integrity, and responsible use of institutional information belonging to the Trust.

Such persons shall not misuse confidential information for personal, political, commercial, institutional, or financial gain.

31.2 Scope of Confidential Information

For the purposes of this Deed, Confidential Information shall include:

(a) Financial Information

- banking records,
- donor details,
- grant documentation,
- funding records,
- expenditure records,
- internal financial planning, and
- institutional financial strategy.

(b) Institutional & Governance Information

- Trustee discussions,
- internal deliberations,
- resolutions prior to formal adoption,
- governance planning,
- legal consultations, and
- institutional strategy.

(c) Research & Academic Material

- unpublished research,
- fieldwork records,
- interviews,
- drafts,
- scholarly collaboration,
- documentary material,
- archival collections,
- source databases, and
- unpublished reports.

(d) Digital & Technical Information

- website administration records,
- internal systems,
- passwords,
- software access,
- digital archives, and
- institutional communication systems.

(e) Personal & Sensitive Information

- personal records of scholars,
- donor information,
- volunteer details,
- contact information, or
- confidential communications lawfully entrusted to the Trust.

31.3 Trustee Confidentiality Obligation

Every Trustee shall:



maintain reasonable confidentiality concerning institutional affairs of the Trust except where disclosure is required by law, Majority Resolution, or legitimate institutional necessity.

No Trustee shall intentionally disclose confidential information where such disclosure:

- harms institutional functioning,
- compromises Trust security,
- damages academic integrity,
- causes financial risk, or
- materially prejudices the interests of Academia Khap.

31.4 Permitted Disclosure

Disclosure of confidential information may be permitted where:

1. Required by law, court order, or lawful authority;
2. Necessary for statutory filing, banking, audit, taxation, or compliance;
3. Authorized through Majority Resolution of Trustees;
4. Necessary for lawful academic collaboration or institutional functioning; or
5. Information has already entered the public domain lawfully.

Disclosure shall be limited to what is reasonably necessary.

31.5 Intellectual & Research Protection

Research materials, drafts, databases, unpublished reports, historical documentation, fieldwork findings, publications under preparation, and institutional research output shall ordinarily remain confidential until:

lawfully published, approved for release, or authorized by the Trustees.

No Trustee or associated person shall misappropriate institutional research for unauthorized personal or external use.

31.6 Digital Security & Records

Trustees and authorized persons entrusted with digital access shall take reasonable care to protect:

- passwords,
- databases,
- archives,
- websites,
- institutional communication,
- cloud storage, and
- digital records

from unauthorized access, misuse, loss, or disclosure.

31.7 Continuing Confidentiality Obligation

The obligation of confidentiality shall ordinarily continue:

even after resignation, removal, cessation of trusteeship, completion of engagement, or termination of association with the Trust, to the extent reasonably necessary for protection of institutional interests.

31.8 Prohibited Conduct

No Trustee or associated person shall:

- leak confidential information for personal advantage,
- misuse donor information,
- unlawfully disclose institutional records,
- commercially exploit Trust material,
- disclose confidential research without authorization, or
- compromise institutional security.



Any serious breach may constitute:

misconduct and grounds for disciplinary action, termination, or removal under this Deed.

31.9 Public Communication Exception

Nothing in this Clause shall prevent the Trust from lawfully publishing:

- research reports,
- educational material,
- public statements,
- media content,
- podcasts,
- institutional updates, or
- awareness initiatives

where approved for public dissemination.

32. Amendment, Modification & Alteration of Trust Deed

32.1 Power to Amend

The Board of Trustees shall possess authority to amend, modify, alter, expand, clarify, revise, or update the provisions of this Trust Deed whenever deemed necessary for:

- institutional growth,
- legal compliance,
- governance improvement,
- operational efficiency,
- research expansion,
- educational advancement,
- financial sustainability, or
- long-term continuity of Academia Khap.

Any amendment shall remain consistent with:

the objectives of the Trust.

32.2 Majority Vote Requirement

No amendment, modification, or alteration to this Trust Deed shall be valid unless approved through:

Majority Vote of the Board of Trustees.

Where the Board consists of three Trustees and all are entitled to vote, two affirmative votes shall ordinarily constitute valid amendment approval. Where the number of Trustees changes in future, Majority Vote shall continue to govern amendments unless otherwise required by law.

32.3 Scope of Amendment

The Trustees may amend, revise, insert, remove, or modify provisions concerning:

- governance procedures,
- operational mechanisms,
- appointment of Trustees,
- institutional administration,
- financial management,
- meeting procedures,
- branch expansion,
- educational activities,
- research structure,
- collaborations,
- digital operations,
- internal regulations, or
- any ancillary matter necessary for proper functioning of the Trust.

32.4 Restrictions on Amendment

Notwithstanding anything contained herein:

No amendment shall alter the fundamental non-profit, public charitable, educational, and institutional character of Academia Khap.

Further:

No amendment shall permit:

- private ownership of Trust assets,
- unlawful distribution of Trust property,
- conversion of Trust funds for personal benefit,
- unilateral control by any Trustee, or
- actions contrary to applicable law.

The principles of:



equal governance, majority-based decision making, institutional accountability, and joint financial safeguards

shall remain protected unless lawfully modified through proper institutional process and applicable law.

32.5 Future Modification Allowed

The Trustees expressly acknowledge that institutional needs, legal requirements, research scope, educational activities, and operational realities may evolve over time.

Accordingly:

Future modification, expansion, clarification, or restructuring of this Trust Deed shall be permitted wherever reasonably necessary for advancement, continuity, and lawful functioning of Academia Khap.

The Trust Deed shall therefore be interpreted as a living institutional document capable of future lawful development.

32.6 Documentation of Amendment

Every amendment shall be:

- recorded in Minutes of Meeting,
- passed through Trustee Resolution,
- documented in institutional records, and
- executed or registered where required under applicable law.

The Trustees may maintain updated versions or supplementary amendment records for institutional continuity.

32.7 Legal Compliance

Any amendment requiring registration, legal filing, notification, or statutory compliance shall be undertaken in accordance with applicable law.

Where applicable:

Minor administrative or procedural modifications not requiring legal registration may be implemented through Trustee Resolution where legally permissible.

33. Indemnity, Protection & Limitation of Personal Liability of Trustees

33.1 Principle of Good Faith Protection

Every Trustee of Academia Khap, including the Chairman, Managing Trustee, Founding Trustees, and any future Trustee, shall be protected against personal liability for acts, decisions, omissions, expenditures, or institutional actions undertaken:

honestly, in good faith, with reasonable care, and in the bona fide interest of the Trust.

Such protection applies only where actions are undertaken within the scope of authority granted under this Trust Deed and applicable law.

33.2 Trustee Indemnity

Subject to the provisions of this Clause:

The Trust shall indemnify and hold harmless every Trustee from personal liability, loss, claim, expense, proceeding, legal cost, or financial burden arising out of lawful acts performed in good faith on behalf of Academia Khap.

Such indemnity may extend to:

- legal proceedings,
- administrative actions,
- regulatory inquiries,
- institutional disputes,
- contractual actions undertaken for Trust purposes,
- compliance-related matters, or
- expenses reasonably incurred while acting for the Trust.

33.3 Protection from Personal Financial Liability

No Trustee shall ordinarily be personally liable for:

- debts of the Trust,
- institutional obligations,
- contractual liabilities of the Trust,
- lawful financial commitments, or
- acts undertaken in official capacity

merely by reason of serving as Trustee.

Accordingly:

Trust liabilities shall ordinarily remain liabilities of the Trust and not personal liabilities of individual Trustees.

33.4 Reimbursement of Legal & Institutional Expenses

Where a Trustee incurs legal, professional, administrative, travel, or compliance-related expenses while:

- defending Trust interests,
- responding to institutional proceedings,
- representing the Trust lawfully, or
- acting in good faith for Trust purposes,

the Trust may reimburse such expenses subject to:

Majority Resolution of Trustees.

The concerned Trustee shall abstain from voting on matters directly concerning his own reimbursement where material conflict exists.

33.5 Limitation of Indemnity

The protection and indemnity under this Clause shall not apply where a Trustee is found to have engaged in:

- fraud,
- wilful misconduct,
- bad faith actions,
- criminal conduct,
- intentional violation of law,
- gross negligence,
- concealment of material information,
- misappropriation of Trust funds or assets, or
- personal enrichment at the expense of the Trust.

No Trustee shall be indemnified for unlawful conduct or intentional wrongdoing.

33.6 Reliance on Professional Advice

A Trustee acting reasonably upon:

- legal advice,
- accounting advice,
- financial guidance,
- academic consultation, or
- professional recommendations

obtained in good faith for Trust purposes shall ordinarily be protected from personal liability arising from bona fide reliance upon such advice.

33.7 Collective Governance Protection

No Trustee shall be personally liable for a decision lawfully approved through:

Majority Resolution of the Board of Trustees

where such Trustee acted:

- honestly,
- reasonably, and
- in good faith.

Dissent or objection may be recorded in Minutes where considered necessary.

33.8 Continuing Protection

The indemnity and protection provided under this Clause shall ordinarily continue:

even after resignation, removal, cessation of office, or completion of trusteeship, in respect of actions lawfully undertaken during the Trustee's tenure.

34. Common Seal, Custody of Documents & Institutional Records

34.1 Common Seal of the Trust

The Trust may, if considered necessary by the Board of Trustees, adopt and maintain an official Common Seal, institutional stamp, or authorized insignia for lawful institutional use.

Such seal may be used for purposes including:

- official documentation,
- agreements,
- institutional correspondence,
- certifications,
- publications,
- legal records, or
- formal execution of Trust-related matters.

Where applicable:

Absence of a Common Seal shall not invalidate the legal existence or functioning of Academia Khap unless specifically required by applicable law.

34.2 Custody of Common Seal

Where a Common Seal is adopted:

The custody of the Common Seal shall remain with the Chairman or such Trustee as may be authorized through Majority Resolution of the Board of Trustees.

Use of the Seal shall require:

- institutional necessity, and
- approval of at least Two (2) Trustees.

No Trustee shall misuse or independently employ the Seal for unauthorized purposes.

34.3 Custody of Trust Documents

The original Trust records and institutional documents of Academia Khap shall ordinarily remain in secure administrative custody with the Managing Trustee, Mr. Deepak Dhillon, for administrative custody purposes only, without exclusive ownership, control, restriction of access, or superior authority over Trust records, and subject always to equal ownership, equal access, and equal governance rights of all Trustees.

The Chairman and other Trustees shall possess equal right to inspect, review, verify, or access Trust records at reasonable times.

34.4 Documents Covered Under Custody

The term Trust Documents shall include:

(a) Legal Documents

- original Trust Deed,
- amendments,
- registration certificates,
- PAN records,
- tax records,
- legal agreements,
- contracts, and
- statutory filings.

(b) Governance Records

- Minutes of Meetings,
- Trustee Resolutions,
- appointment records,
- consent letters, and



- internal governance documents.
- (c) Financial Records
 - bank statements,
 - vouchers,
 - donation records,
 - grants documentation,
 - expense registers,
 - audit records, and
 - financial reports.
- (d) Institutional & Research Records
 - publications,
 - research data,
 - digital archives,
 - photographs,
 - videos,
 - documentary material,
 - scholar agreements, and
 - institutional databases.

34.5 Digital Record Custody

The Trust may maintain:

- cloud storage,
- digital backups,
- encrypted archives,
- institutional email systems, or
- secure digital repositories

for preservation of institutional continuity.

Where practicable:

At least Two (2) Trustees shall possess access to essential institutional digital systems to prevent unilateral control or loss of records.

34.6 Access Rights of Trustees

No Trustee shall exclusively monopolize institutional records.

Accordingly:

Every Trustee shall possess equal right to inspect, review, copy, or access Trust records and institutional documentation.

No material document shall be intentionally concealed from Trustees without lawful justification.

34.7 Transfer of Custody

In the event of:

- resignation,
- removal,
- incapacity,
- death, or
- change of administrative responsibility,

the Trustee having custody of institutional records shall:

promptly hand over all Trust documents, records, passwords, archives, property, and institutional material to the Board of Trustees or authorized successor.

No Trustee shall retain institutional property for personal control.

34.8 Loss, Misuse or Destruction of Records

No Trustee or associated person shall intentionally:



- destroy,
- conceal,
- falsify,
- alter, or
- unlawfully remove

Trust records or institutional documents.

Any intentional misuse may constitute:

misconduct and grounds for removal under this Deed.

35. Dissolution, Winding Up & Disposal of Trust Assets

35.1 Dissolution of the Trust

The Trust known as Academia Khap shall ordinarily continue as a perpetual charitable and educational institution.

However, the Trust may be dissolved, wound up, or terminated only where:

- continuation becomes impossible,
- institutional functioning becomes impracticable,
- legal circumstances require dissolution,
- objectives of the Trust can no longer reasonably be fulfilled, or
- the Trustees collectively determine that dissolution is unavoidable.

Dissolution shall always remain:

a measure of last resort and undertaken strictly in accordance with law.

35.2 Majority Approval Requirement

No dissolution or winding up of the Trust shall be valid unless approved through:

Majority Resolution of the Board of Trustees.

Where the Board consists of three Trustees and all are entitled to vote, two affirmative votes shall ordinarily be required for initiation of dissolution proceedings. Such Resolution shall be properly recorded in:

- Minutes of Meeting,
- Trustee Resolution, and
- institutional records.

35.3 Settlement of Liabilities

Before any dissolution, the Trustees shall ensure that:

all lawful liabilities, obligations, dues, expenses, taxes, contracts, salaries, honorarium, grants, legal claims, and financial commitments of the Trust are appropriately settled or lawfully discharged.

Such liabilities may include:

- outstanding payments,
- research commitments,
- contractual obligations,
- employee or consultant dues,
- taxes or statutory liabilities,
- legal expenses, and
- institutional financial obligations.

No dissolution shall proceed without reasonable effort to discharge lawful liabilities.

35.4 Disposal of Remaining Assets

Upon settlement of liabilities:

Any remaining movable or immovable property, institutional assets, grants, corpus, archives, publications, intellectual property, equipment, books, research material, digital records, goodwill, and financial resources of the Trust shall not be distributed personally among Trustees.

Instead:

The remaining assets shall be transferred, assigned, donated, or applied to another trust, institution, educational body, research institution, charitable organization, or public welfare entity having substantially similar similar charitable, educational, or research-oriented objectives.

Preference may be given to organizations engaged in:

- education,
- historical research,



- cultural preservation,
- academic work,
- social welfare, or
- public charitable activity.

35.5 No Personal Distribution

Notwithstanding anything contained in this Deed:

No Trustee, including the Chairman, Managing Trustee, Founding Trustee, or any successor Trustee, shall receive personal ownership, monetary distribution, institutional property, residual assets, corpus, or financial benefit arising from dissolution of the Trust.

Accordingly:

Trust assets shall never be treated as privately divisible property.

35.6 Preservation of Research & Institutional Material

Where reasonably practicable:

Research archives, publications, historical records, digital repositories, educational material, and institutional documentation of Academia Khap shall be preserved, archived, or transferred to a suitable educational or research-oriented institution to ensure continuity of public benefit.

35.7 Legal Compliance

All dissolution proceedings shall be undertaken in accordance with:

- applicable law,
- registration requirements,
- charitable trust regulations,
- taxation requirements, and
- institutional compliance obligations.

35.8 Institutional Intent

This Clause is intended to ensure:

responsible winding up, lawful settlement of liabilities, protection of charitable assets, prevention of private appropriation, and preservation of public educational value of Academia Khap.

36. Dispute Resolution, Governing Law & Jurisdiction

36.1 Internal Resolution of Disputes

In the event of any disagreement, dispute, conflict, misunderstanding, or difference arising between Trustees concerning:

- governance,
- finances,
- appointments,
- interpretation of this Trust Deed,
- institutional functioning,
- decision-making,
- property,
- operational matters, or
- any issue concerning Academia Khap,

the Trustees shall first make reasonable efforts to resolve such dispute internally through: discussion, consultation, deliberation, and Majority-based institutional decision making in good faith.

The Trustees shall endeavor to preserve institutional continuity and avoid unnecessary disruption to the charitable objectives of the Trust.

36.2 Good Faith Consultation

Before initiating any formal legal action:

The concerned Trustee(s) shall ordinarily attempt good-faith consultation and amicable resolution through a properly convened Trustee Meeting.

Where appropriate, the Trustees may also mutually seek assistance from:

- legal advisors,
- mediators,
- financial professionals, or
- independent institutional experts

for facilitating resolution.

Such advisors shall not possess voting authority over Trust affairs.

36.3 Majority Decision Principle

In matters relating to governance and internal functioning of the Trust:

The lawful Majority Resolution of Trustees shall prevail and remain binding upon the Trust and all Trustees.

No Trustee shall intentionally obstruct institutional functioning after lawful Majority Resolution except where clear illegality or fraud is alleged.

36.4 Legal Proceedings

Where a dispute cannot reasonably be resolved internally and legal intervention becomes unavoidable:

The matter may be referred to competent legal proceedings in accordance with applicable law.

The Trustees shall endeavor to protect the reputation, continuity, charitable character, and lawful functioning of Academia Khap during any dispute.

36.5 Governing Law

This Trust Deed and all matters relating to:

- governance,
- administration,



- finances,
- interpretation,
- trustee obligations,
- dissolution, and
- institutional functioning

shall be governed by:

the laws of India and applicable laws of the State of Haryana.

36.6 Exclusive Jurisdiction

For all legal proceedings, claims, disputes, litigation, or matters arising out of or connected with this Trust Deed or the affairs of Academia Khap:

The Courts and competent authorities having territorial jurisdiction in Jhajjar District, Haryana, shall ordinarily possess exclusive jurisdiction.

Where jurisdiction is mandated otherwise by law, proceedings may be undertaken before the legally competent authority.

36.7 Protection of Institutional Interest

During pendency of any dispute:

No Trustee shall unlawfully appropriate Trust property, freeze institutional functioning, conceal records, misuse finances, or damage the lawful interests of Academia Khap.

The Trustees shall continue to act in good faith toward preservation of institutional assets and continuity wherever reasonably practicable.

37. Severability Clause

37.1 Severability

If any provision, clause, sentence, or part of this Trust Deed is held invalid, unlawful, or unenforceable by any competent court or authority, such invalidity shall not affect the remaining provisions of this Deed, which shall continue to remain valid and enforceable to the fullest extent permitted by law.

37.2 Interpretation of Deed

This Trust Deed shall be read and interpreted as a whole in a manner that gives effect to the charitable, educational, research, and public welfare intent of the Trust.

38. Execution, Signatures & Attestation

38.1 Execution of Trust Deed

This Deed of Declaration of Public Charitable Educational Trust establishing “ACADEMIA KHAP” shall be deemed duly executed upon:

signing, dating, and attestation by the Trustees and Witnesses in accordance with applicable law.

The Trustees hereby declare that they have voluntarily entered into this Trust Deed:

- in sound mind,
- without coercion,
- without undue influence, and
- with full understanding of the charitable, educational, and institutional objectives of the Trust.

38.2 Acceptance by Trustees

By execution of this Trust Deed, the undersigned Trustees hereby:

- accept appointment as Trustees of Academia Khap,
- agree to discharge fiduciary obligations in good faith,
- undertake to act in accordance with this Deed, and
- commit to advancement of the charitable, educational, historical, cultural, research, and welfare objectives of the Trust.

38.3 Date of Execution

This Trust Deed shall be executed on:

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

at:

Place of Execution: Jhajjar, Haryana, India

and shall take effect from the date of execution unless otherwise provided by law.

38.4 Signatures of Trustees

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the undersigned Trustees have executed this Trust Deed on the date and place mentioned above.

Signatures of Trustees

1. Chairman & Founding Trustee

Name: Mr. Harsh Chaudhary

Signature: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

2. Managing Trustee & Founding Trustee

Name: Mr. Deepak Dhillon

Signature: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

3. Trustee

Name: Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist

Signature: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026



38.5 Witnesses

This Trust Deed is witnessed and attested by the following independent witnesses:

Witness – 1

Name: _____

Father's / Spouse Name: _____

Address: _____

Mobile No.: _____

Signature: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

Witness – 2

Name: _____

Father's / Spouse Name: _____

Address: _____

Mobile No.: _____

Signature: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

38.6 Attestation

The Trustees and Witnesses hereby affirm that:

the contents of this Trust Deed have been read, understood, accepted, and voluntarily executed for establishment and lawful functioning of Academia Khap as a Public Charitable Educational Trust.

38.7 Custody of Executed Original

The original executed Trust Deed shall remain in safe custody of the Trust and may be retained at: the Registered Office of Academia Khap or such location as approved by the Trustees.

Certified copies may be maintained for:

- registration purposes,
- banking purposes,
- taxation,
- institutional records, or
- legal compliance.

39. Witness Attestation Pages

Witness Attestation Page – 1

Declaration of Witness

I, the undersigned Witness, do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that:

1. I personally know and/or have identified the persons executing this Trust Deed of Academia Khap;
2. The Trustees signed and executed this Deed voluntarily, in my presence, and to the best of my knowledge:

in sound mind, free will, and without coercion, undue influence, fraud, or misrepresentation;

3. I have witnessed the execution of this Trust Deed on the date and place mentioned herein;
4. I understand that my role is limited to witnessing and attesting the execution of this Deed and does not create any ownership, governance, fiduciary, financial, or legal interest in the Trust.

PARTICULARS OF Witness – 1

Full Name: _____

Father's / Spouse Name: _____

Occupation: _____

Age: _____

Permanent Address: _____

Mobile Number: _____

Email ID (Optional): _____

Identity Proof (Aadhaar / PAN / DL / Voter ID):

Identity Number: _____

SIGNATURE OF Witness – 1

Signature: _____

Name of Witness: _____

Place: Jhajjar, Haryana

Date: ____ / ____ / 20____

Signatures of Trustees IN PRESENCE OF Witness – 1

Trustee Name

Mr. Harsh Chaudhary

Mr. Deepak Dhillon

Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist

Signature



Declaration of Witness

I, the undersigned Witness, do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that:

1. I personally know and/or have identified the persons executing this Trust Deed of Academia Khap;
2. The Trustees signed and executed this Deed voluntarily, in my presence, and to the best of my knowledge:

in sound mind, free will, and without coercion, undue influence, fraud, or misrepresentation;

3. I have witnessed the execution of this Trust Deed on the date and place mentioned herein;
4. I understand that my role is limited to witnessing and attesting the execution of this Deed and does not create any ownership, governance, fiduciary, financial, or legal interest in the Trust.

PARTICULARS OF Witness – 2

Full Name: _____

Father's / Spouse Name: _____

Occupation: _____

Age: _____

Permanent Address: _____

Mobile Number: _____

Email ID (Optional): _____

Identity Proof (Aadhaar / PAN / DL / Voter ID):

Identity Number: _____

SIGNATURE OF Witness – 2

Signature: _____

Name of Witness: _____

Place: Jhajjar, Haryana

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026

Signatures of Trustees IN PRESENCE OF Witness – 2

Trustee Name

Signature

Mr. Harsh Chaudhary

Mr. Deepak Dhillon

Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist

Final Attestation

We, the undersigned Witnesses, hereby affirm that:

The Trust Deed of "ACADEMIA KHAP" was voluntarily executed by the Trustees in our presence, and we attest the authenticity of the signatures affixed herein.

Witness

Signature

Witness – 1

Witness – 2



Annexure A

Particulars of Trustees of Academia Khap

(Forming Integral Part of the Trust Deed of “ACADEMIA KHAP”)

This Annexure – A forms an integral and inseparable part of the Deed of Declaration of Public Charitable Educational Trust of Academia Khap and records the particulars of the Initial Trustees of the Trust.

The Trustees hereby affirm that the particulars provided below are true to the best of their knowledge and shall be updated, where necessary, in accordance with law and Trustee Resolution.

Trustee – 1 Chairman & Founding Trustee

Particular	Details
Full Name	Mr. Harsh Chaudhary
Father's Name	_____
Date of Birth	____ / ____ / ____
Nationality	Indian
Occupation	_____
Residential Address	_____ _____ _____
Mobile Number	_____
Email Address	_____
Aadhaar Number	_____
PAN Number	_____
Designation in Trust	Chairman & Founding Trustee
Signature of Trustee – 1	Signature: _____
Date: ____ / ____ / 20 ____	



Trustee – 2
Managing Trustee & Founding Trustee

Particular	Details
Full Name	Mr. Deepak Dhillon
Father's Name	_____
Date of Birth	____ / ____ / ____
Nationality	Indian
Occupation	_____
Residential Address	_____ _____ _____
Mobile Number	_____
Email Address	_____
Aadhaar Number	_____
PAN Number	_____
Designation in Trust	Managing & Founding Trustee
Signature of Trustee – 2	Signature: _____
Date: ____ / ____ / 20 ____	



Trustee – 3
TRUSTEE

Particular	Details
Full Name	Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist
Father's Name	_____
Date of Birth	____ / ____ / ____
Nationality	Indian
Occupation	_____
Residential Address	_____ _____ _____
Mobile Number	_____
Email Address	_____
Aadhaar Number	_____
PAN Number	_____
Designation in Trust	Trustee
Signature of Trustee – 3	Signature: _____

Date: / / 2026

Declaration of Trustees

We, the undersigned Trustees of Academia Khap, hereby affirm that:

The particulars furnished in this Annexure are true and correct to the best of our knowledge and belief, and we undertake to promptly notify any material change to the Trust records wherever required.

Signatures of Trustees

Trustee Name	Signature
Mr. Harsh Chaudhary	
Mr. Deepak Dhillon	
Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist	

Place: Jhajjar, Haryana

Date: / / 2026

Annexure B

Registered Office Details of Academia Khap

(Forming Integral Part of the Trust Deed of “ACADEMIA KHAP”)

This Annexure – B forms an integral and inseparable part of the Deed of Declaration of Public Charitable Educational Trust of Academia Khap and records the particulars of the Registered Office of the Trust.

The Registered Office shall be maintained for purposes including:

- legal correspondence,
- institutional communication,
- maintenance of Trust records,
- statutory compliance,
- official notices, and
- administrative functioning of the Trust.

1. Registered Office of the Trust

The Registered Office of Academia Khap shall presently be situated at:

Registered Address

House / Building No.: _____

Street / Locality / Village: _____

Tehsil / Area: _____

District: Jhajjar

State: Haryana

PIN Code: _____

Country: India

Contact Details of Registered Office

Official Email (if any): _____

Official Mobile Number (if any): _____

2. Ownership / Occupancy Status

The Registered Office premises shall be situated at:

- ☐ Self-Owned Property of Trustee / Supporter
- ☐ Rented Property
- ☐ Leased Property
- ☐ Premises Provided Through No Objection Certificate (NOC)
- ☐ Other: _____

Where the premises are not owned by the Trust:

A valid No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the lawful owner/occupant may be maintained as part of institutional records wherever required by law or registration authority.



3. Change of Registered Office

The Board of Trustees may change, relocate, shift, or establish a new Registered Office of the Trust within:

- Jhajjar District,
- Haryana, or
- any other place in India,

whenever reasonably required for institutional functioning.

Where applicable:

Such relocation shall require Majority Resolution of Trustees.

The Trustees shall undertake necessary legal or administrative formalities wherever required under applicable law.

4. Custody of Records

The Registered Office may ordinarily serve as the place for custody of:

- original Trust Deed,
- amendments,
- resolutions,
- books of accounts,
- vouchers,
- institutional records,
- banking documents,
- legal records, and
- research archives,

unless otherwise resolved by the Board of Trustees.

5. Declaration

The Trustees hereby affirm that:

The Registered Office details mentioned herein shall constitute the official correspondence address of Academia Khap unless lawfully modified through Trustee Resolution.

Signatures of Trustees

Trustee Name

Mr. Harsh Chaudhary

Mr. Deepak Dhillon

Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist

Signature

Place: Jhajjar, Haryana

Date: ____ / ____ / 2026



Annexure C

Trustee Identity & Document Checklist

(Forming Integral Part of the Trust Deed of “ACADEMIA KHAP”)

This Annexure – C forms an integral and inseparable part of the Deed of Declaration of Public Charitable Educational Trust of Academia Khap and records the documentary requirements ordinarily required for registration, compliance, banking, statutory records, and institutional administration of the Trust.

The Trustees may furnish copies of documents as required by:

- Registration Authority,
- Sub-Registrar Office,
- Banking Institutions,
- Tax Authorities, or
- other lawful authorities.

1. Document Checklist – Trustee Wise

Trustee – 1, Mr. Harsh Chaudhary (Chairman & Founding Trustee)

Document	Required	Attached	Remarks
Aadhaar Card Copy	☒	☐	_____
PAN Card Copy	☒	☐	_____
Passport Size Photograph	☒	☐	_____
Mobile Number	☒	☐	_____
Email Address	☒	☐	_____
Address Proof	☒	☐	_____
Signature Specimen	☒	☐	_____
Occupation Details	☒	☐	_____
Date of Birth Proof	☒	☐	_____

Trustee – 2, Mr. Deepak Dhillon (Managing Trustee & Founding Trustee)

Document	Required	Attached	Remarks
Aadhaar Card Copy	☒	☐	_____
PAN Card Copy	☒	☐	_____
Passport Size Photograph	☒	☐	_____
Mobile Number	☒	☐	_____
Email Address	☒	☐	_____
Address Proof	☒	☐	_____
Signature Specimen	☒	☐	_____
Occupation Details	☒	☐	_____
Date of Birth Proof	☒	☐	_____

Trustee – 3, Mr. Ajay Kumar Vashist (Trustee)

Document	Required	Attached	Remarks
Aadhaar Card Copy	☒	☐	_____
PAN Card Copy	☒	☐	_____
Passport Size Photograph	☒	☐	_____
Mobile Number	☒	☐	_____
Email Address	☒	☐	_____
Address Proof	☒	☐	_____
Signature Specimen	☒	☐	_____
Occupation Details	☒	☐	_____
Date of Birth Proof	☒	☐	_____

2. Registered Office Documents Checklist

Document	Required	Attached	Remarks
Registered Office Address Proof	☒	☐	_____
Electricity Bill / Water Bill / Property Tax Record	☒	☐	_____
Rent Agreement (if rented)	☐	☐	_____
Lease Agreement (if leased)	☐	☐	_____
No Objection Certificate (NOC) from Property Owner	☒	☐	_____
Owner Aadhaar Copy	☒	☐	_____
Owner PAN Copy	☐	☐	_____

3. Trust Registration Documents Checklist

Document	Required	Attached	Remarks
Final Executed Trust Deed	☒	☐	_____
Stamp Paper / E-Stamp	☒	☐	_____
Passport Size Photos of Trustees	☒	☐	_____
Trustee Consent Letters	☒	☐	_____
Trustee Declarations	☒	☐	_____
Witness Identity Proofs	☒	☐	_____
Witness Signatures	☒	☐	_____
Registered Office NOC	☒	☐	_____
Annexures A–C	☒	☐	_____

4. Bank Account Opening Document Checklist

Document	Required	Attached	Remarks
Registered Trust Deed Copy	☒	☐	_____
PAN Card of Trust	☒	☐	_____
Registration Certificate	☒	☐	_____
Trustee KYC Documents	☒	☐	_____
Resolution for Opening Bank Account	☒	☐	_____
Passport Size Photographs	☒	☐	_____
Mobile & Email for Banking	☒	☐	_____
Registered Office Proof	☒	☐	_____
Authorized Signatory Resolution	☒	☐	_____

5. Declaration

The Trustees hereby affirm that:

The documents listed in this Annexure shall be maintained for lawful registration, banking, institutional administration, and compliance purposes of Academia Khap.

The checklist may be modified, expanded, or updated as per:

- legal requirements,
- registration authority instructions,
- banking requirements, or
- future institutional needs.